EPISODE 1

TITLE: **FALLING FOR THE RIVAL**

EPISODE 1: **UNEXPECTED ENCOUNTER**

INT. RENATA'S OFFICE - DAY

Renata (28, sharp yet stylish) sits at her cluttered desk, scrolling through emails with a growing look of frustration.

ON SCREEN: An email titled "Project Termination Notice."

She exhales sharply and grabs her phone.

RENATA

(INTO PHONE)

Garrett, I just got the termination notice from them. What do we do now?

CUT TO:

INT. GARRETT'S OFFICE - DAY

Garrett (30s, warm smile but serious eyes) leans against his desk by the window, looking out thoughtfully before

responding.

GARRETT

We'll find another investor. Don't worry yetthere's still time.

CUT TO:

INT. RENATA'S OFFICE CONTINUOUS

Renata forces a small smile but it fades quickly as she looks down at her screen again.

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Suddenlyher assistant bursts in holding an invitation card high like a trophy.

ASSISTANT
Miss Wells! This is your VIP pass!

Renata raises an eyebrow as she takes ita sleek black card embossed with gold lettering reading "Sovereign Throne Gala."

ASSISTANT (CONT'D)
The gala tonight is going to be packed with top-tier investors! If you can land even one deal there...

Her voice trails off in excitement while Renata stares at the card quietly calculating possibilities.

EXT./ INT. HOTEL LOBBY/BALLROOM NIGHT

The grand hotel lobby glimmers under crystal chandeliers as elegantly dressed guests mingle beneath soaring ceilings and

polished marble floors reflecting their glittering gowns and tuxedos like stars on earth .

In walks Renata wearing an eye-catching red dress that perfectly complements her figure turning heads instantly . She steps

forward confidently toward registration when suddenly

A tall man intercepts her path , blocking access . His face remains unreadable behind dark sunglasses .

MAN IN SUIT #1
This event requires strict invitations only . You're not on any list here .

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Before Renata can respond , another suited figure appears beside him equally imposing ; this one wears mirrored shades too .

MAN IN SUIT #2

(VOICE COLD & AUTHORITATIVE)
You really shouldn't be here without proper clearance . Leave immediately or we'll have security escort you out !

Guests nearby glance over curiously , whispers ripple through crowd about potential drama unfolding right before

their eyes

JUST THEN

A deep voice cuts through tension like steel slicing air :

NICHOLAS MERCER stands tall between them arms crossed casually across broad chest gaze fixed firmly ahead without need for

expression behind tinted lenses .

His presence commands absolute authority; even shadows seem to recoil respectfully around him

EPISODE 2

Nicholas pulls off his sunglasses, revealing a sharp, commanding gaze that instantly silences the room.

NICHOLAS

(VOICE LOW AND AUTHORITATIVE)
I'm Nicholas Mercer. This event is under my jurisdiction tonight.

The two men exchange a quick glance before stepping aside without another word. Renata blinks in surprise, then steps

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forward with measured grace.

RENATA

(SMILING SOFTLY)
Thank you for your assistance, Mr. Mercer.

Nicholas tilts his head slightly but says nothing as he leads her through the lobby toward the ballroom entrance. The crowd

parts like waves around themsome lingering to steal glances, others whispering about the unexpected disruption.

Once inside the ballroom's grand doors, Nicholas finally speaks voice calm yet firm:

NICHOLAS
This gala isn't open to just anyone especially not someone sneaking in without an invitation.

Renata meets his eyes steadily no hint of fear or hesitation in her expression.

RENATA

(FIRMLY)
I'm not here by chance or deceit. I have every right to be at this eventand I intend to secure investment for my project tonight.

Her words hang in the air like sparks ready to ignite tension between them

Before their silent standoff can escalate further

A warm hand suddenly rests lightly on Renata's shoulder from behind . She turns , surprised , into Garrett Vale 's

familiar smile . His presence instantly shifts atmosphere; tension dissipates .

GARRETT

(LOW & REASSURING)
Renata! There you areI've been looking all over for you!

He gently takes her arm and begins guiding her deeper into the crowd , leaving Nicholas standing alone near entrance

watching silently

Their eyes meet across distance one last time

NICHOLAS (V.O.)

(SMIRKING SLIGHTLY)
Interesting woman...

FADE OUT.

EPISODE 3

INT. BALLROOM ENTRANCE - NIGHT

Nicholas watches Renata and Garrett disappear into the crowd, a faint smile lingering on his lips.

NICHOLAS (V.O.)

(SMIRKING SLIGHTLY)
Interesting woman...

Suddenly, his phone buzzes. He glances at itan incoming call from "Lily." His expression shifts to something softer.

NICHOLAS

(INTO PHONE)
Hey, Lily. What's up?

INTERCUT PHONE CONVERSATION:

LILY (O.S., EXCITED)
Nick! You won't believe itI got an exclusive interview with the CEO of Sovereign Throne Industries!

Nicholas chuckles softly.

NICHOLAS (V.O.)

(CHUCKLING)

ALWAYS CHASING THE NEXT SCOOP

He turns back toward the ballroom doors but pauses, one hand resting lightly against the frame as if reluctant to leave.

His eyes drift back toward where Renata disappeared moments agoa flicker of curiosity in their depths.

Then he steps away without another thought and disappears into the night outside.

FADE OUT.

EPISODE 4

INT. LUXURY HOTEL BALLROOM - NIGHT

The grand doors swing open, and Renata steps out with Garrett, both scanning the crowd.

GARRETT

(WHISPERING)

Now what?

Renata's eyes lock onto a man across the roomdashing in a tailored suit, his presence commanding.

RENATA

(LOW VOICE)

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There. That's himthe CEO of Sovereign Throne Industries.

Garrett follows her gaze, frowning slightly.

GARRETT

(CONFUSED)
But he looks so young... Are you sure?

Before she can respond, the man turns abruptly toward them. Their eyes meethis gaze piercing and unsettlingly intense.

CEO (V.O.) / NICHOLAS MERCER

A slow smile spreads across Nicholas's face as he strides directly toward them, each step deliberate and composed.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(SMOOTHLY)
I don't think we've met before. I'm Nicholas Mercer CEO of Sovereign Throne Industries. And you are?

Renata freezes for half a second before instinctively stepping forward to shake his handbut then she hesitates again,

pulling back quickly with an awkward chuckle.

RENATA WELLS (V.O.) / HEROINE (O.S.)

Wait this guy just stopped me from entering that gala earlier!

Her expression shifts to confusion mixed with suspicion as she studies him more closelythen glances at Garrett beside her

for reassurance.

GARRETT VALE (V.O.) / SUPPORTING MALE LEAD (O.S.)

Dammit... This is gonna be complicated...

Nicholas tilts his head slightly at their odd interaction but remains perfectly composedwith an almost predatory calmness

in his gaze aimed solely at Renata.

/ END EPISODE 4

EPISODE 5

Nicholas's gaze sharpens, lingering on Renata with unsettling intensity.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(CALM, DELIBERATE)

Ms. Wells... you're the one who was denied entry just now?

Renata stiffens, caught off guard by his directness.

RENATA WELLS

(SURPRISED)

Yes... How do you know that?

Nicholas lets out a low chucklesmooth and almost amused.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(LEANING IN SLIGHTLY)

Because I'm the one who turned you away.

The words hit like ice. Garrett immediately steps closer to Renata, protective instinct kicking in.

GARRETT VALE

(LOW, WARNING)

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You shouldn't have interfered with her invitation. That gala is for those of true status and

Before Garrett can finish, Nicholas cuts him off with a raised hand and a dismissive wave.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(FLATLY)

Status? What makes you think this event is only for people like us?

He turns back to Renata, voice dropping into something softeralmost intimate.

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)

But if it were up to me right now Ms. Wells would be more than welcome here tonight.

Renata's eyes widen in shock at his wordsand then she glances at Garrett nervously.

RENATA WELLS (V.O.) / HEROINE (O.S.)

What does he mean by that...? Is he serious? Or just messing with me?

Garrett notices her hesitation and tightens his grip on her arm before shooting Nicholas a glare filled with

defiancebut Nicholas remains unfazed. His attention never leaves Renata as he takes another step forwardclosing the distance

between them even further.

/ END EPISODE 5

EPISODE 6

Nicholas closes the distance between them, his presence overwhelming.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(LOW, DELIBERATE)
I said Ms. Wells would be more than welcome here tonight.

His gaze flickers to Garrett for a split second before returning to Renatahis tone shifting into something almost seductive.

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)

(SMOOTHLY)
If you come with me I can guarantee you'll have the best time imaginable.

Renata blinks, stunned by his wordsand then instinctively steps back, breaking free of Garrett's grasp as she pulls her arm away.

RENATA WELLS

(COLD, FIRM)
Thank youbut no thanks.

Garrett exhales sharply in relief and reaches out to steady herbut Nicholas is already turning on his heel and walking away without another word.

/ END EPISODE 6

EPISODE 7

INT. HOTEL LOBBY - NIGHT

Renata exhales sharply, her pulse still racing as she watches Nicholas disappear into the crowd.

GARRETT VALE

(URGENT, PROTECTIVE)
Are you okay? That guy... he gives me the creeps.

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RENATA WELLS

(TRYING TO STEADY HERSELF)
I'm fine. Honestly, I don't even know why I reacted like that.

Garrett steps closer, lowering his voice.

GARRETT VALE
He's dangerouspowerful and unpredictable. You should be careful around him.

Before Renata can respond, a sharp SNAP echoes from behind themthe sound of a camera flash.

PHOTOGRAPHER (O.S.)
Perfect shot! This is going viral!

Renata spins around in shock. Several photographers have swarmed the lobby entrance, their cameras flashing

relentlessly toward her and Garrett. The headlines are already forming in their minds:

"Scandal at Luxury Hotel: Woman Rejects Young CEO's Seductive Offer!"

"Unseen Rivalry Sparks Tension Between Elite Figures!"

The glare of the lights stings Renata's eyes as she instinctively raises an arm to shield herselfbut it only draws more

attention.

RENATA WELLS

(FIRMLY)
Enough! This is ridiculousI didn't do anything wrong!

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Her voice cuts through the chaos for a brief moment before another FLASH blinds her again. She glances at Garrett; his

expression mirrors hersfrustrated and helpless under this sudden media assault.

/ END EPISODE 7

EPISODE 8

Garrett quickly moves to block the cameras, his hands raised in a protective stance.

GARRETT VALE

(TO THE PHOTOGRAPHERS)
Enough! You've crossed the line!

The photographers hesitate for a moment, but their lenses keep clicking. Renata's gaze flickers nervously between them and

Garrett.

RENATA WELLS

(WHISPERING)
I'll handle this. Stay here.

Before Garrett can protest, Renata strides toward the cluster of reporters with unexpected confidence. She stops just

short of them and lifts her chin high.

RENATA WELLS (CONT'D)

(CLEAR, COMMANDING)
If you're going to report on me, get it right. There's no scandaljust business as usual.

Her words hang in the air like a challenge. The lead photographer steps forward, smirking slightly before raising

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his camera again.

PHOTOGRAPHER

(SMIRKING)

And what exactly happened here? Care to give us your side?

Renata pauses deliberately before respondinga calculated move that only fuels their intrigue further.

RENATA WELLS

(CALMLY)

I was simply rejecting an unsolicited proposition from someone who clearly doesn't know boundaries... or respect professional limits.

A ripple of murmurs spreads through the crowd as they exchange glances and snap more photos. Somewhere amidst them is

Nicholaswatching silently from afar with an unreadable expression.

/ END EPISODE 8

EPISODE 9

The lead photographer narrows his eyes, glancing back at Renata with a mix of suspicion and amusement.

PHOTOGRAPHER

(TEASING)

So you're saying this was all about boundaries? Sounds like there's more to the story. Care to elaborate for your fans?

Renata tilts her head slightly, giving them a measured smile that only deepens their curiosity.

RENATA WELLS

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(SMOOTHLY)
I'm not here to feed gossip. If you want the real story, come to my office tomorrow morning. I'll give an exclusive interviewon one condition: no misinterpretation, no twisting words.

The photographers exchange hesitant looks before nodding in agreement, their shutters clicking once more as they

retreat with murmurs of approval.

Just as the crowd begins to disperse, Nicholas steps forward from the shadows. His gaze locks onto Renata's with icy

intensity before he speakshis voice low and deliberate.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(COLD)
You really know how to make an impression... unfortunately, it wasn't on me this time.

Renata turns smoothly toward him but doesn't flinch under his scrutiny. Her expression remains composed yet guardeda

silent challenge in her steady gaze.

/ END EPISODE 9

EPISODE 10

EPISODE 10

Nicholas steps closer, his presence dominating the space between them. He tilts Renata's chin up with one hand,

forcing her to meet his gaze.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(SMIRKING)

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You think you can just play games and walk away? You're in my territory now.

Renata doesn't flinch. Instead, she meets his stare head-on, her voice steady and unyielding.

RENATA WELLS

(CALMLY)

I don't belong to anyone. And I certainly don't take orders from someone I barely knowespecially when they've already proven themselves arrogant and unreasonable.

Nicholas's smirk fades instantly. His grip on her chin tightens for a brief moment before releasing it sharply.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(VOICE LOW, DANGEROUS)

You really have no idea who you're dealing with... but fine. Consider this your firstand lastwarning: stay out of my way if you value your career.

He turns abruptly and strides away without another word.

Renata watches him go, a faint smile tugging at the corner of her lips as she shakes her head slightly in disbelief.

/ END EPISODE 10

EPISODE 11

EPISODE 11

The door slams shut behind Nicholas, leaving the room eerily silent.

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Renata exhales slowly, her eyes drifting to the ceiling as she mutters under her breath.

RENATA WELLS

(TO HERSELF)

Mercer... what kind of man are you?

Suddenly, the sound of heels clicking sharply against the floor breaks the quiet. Renata turns just in time to see

Garrett stride in smoothly, his expression shifting instantly when he spots her.

GARRETT VALE

(VOICE LOW BUT FIRM)

Renata. What exactly do you think you're doing here?

Before she can respond, his gaze flicks toward where Nicholas had been standing moments agonow empty space.

GARRETT VALE (CONT'D)

(SUSPICIOUS)

Did you run into him again? That man is troubleyou need to stay away from him!

Renata crosses her arms defiantly and tilts her chin up slightly.

RENATA WELLS

(FLATLY)

And why should I listen to you about that? You're not exactly free from your own messes either. At least Mercer's straightforwardI know where I stand with him. Unlike someone else who keeps hiding things from me...

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Garrett's jaw tightens; for a split second his composure falters before he masks it with a cold smile.

GARRETT VALE

(CUTTINGLY CALM)

Fine. But if anything happens because of this "straightforward" man... don't expect me not to intervene on behalf of my companyor myself.

He turns abruptly and exits without another word, leaving Renata alone once moreher lips curling into a small smirk

tinged with defiance.

/ END EPISODE 11

EPISODE 12

EPISODE 12

Renata exhales slowly, her smirk fading as she watches Garrett's retreating figure.

RENATA WELLS

(WHISPERING TO HERSELF)

He's right... I can't let this spiral out of control.

Her gaze drifts toward the empty spot where Nicholas had stood just moments ago. She clenches her fist lightly, frustration

flickering in her eyes.

RENATA WELLS (CONT'D)

(TO HERSELF)

Mercer... what exactly are you planning?

The café door swings open again. Renata turns sharplyNicholas steps back inside with his usual calm, but his expression is

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unreadable. He stops when he sees her still seated at the table.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(SMOOTHLY)
Miss Wells. You left rather abruptly earlierwas there something you needed from me? Or perhaps... someone else?

Before she can answer, a loud crash echoes from the corner of the room. Both their heads snap toward the noisea waiter has

dropped a tray full of drinks and dishes onto the floor.

WAITER (O.S.)

(APOLOGETIC AND FLUSTERED)
I'm so sorry! Let me clean that up

As he bends down to gather the scattered items, one glass tips overand clear liquid splashes directly onto Renata's skirt.

RENATA WELLS

(SHOCKED, VOICE RISING SLIGHTLY)
What?!

She jumps up instinctivelybut before she can react further, Nicholas moves in fast and precise. Without hesitation, he grabs

a napkin from another table and presses it against her skirt to soak up the moisture.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(CALMLY EFFICIENT)
Herethis should help for now.

His hands brush against hers briefly as they both hold the napkin steady; an unexpected tension lingers in that

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fleeting contact. Renata feels heat rise to her cheeksnot entirely due to embarrassment anymore.

She glances at him sidewaystheir faces unnervingly close nowand suddenly realizes how intimate this moment looks: two people alone in a public place; one assisting another with personal clothing care...

Her mind races instantly back to Garrett's warning about rumors spreading like wildfire between them because of their closeness lately...

AND WITHOUT THINKING TWICE:

RENATA WELLS
(firm tone cutting through any hesitation)

Fine! If being seen together means trouble for either of usI'll give you what you want!

She stands tall again and meets Nicholas' gaze head-onwith unwavering confidence dripping from every word:

RENATA WELLS (CONT'D)
But only on one condition: we make our partnership official first . And then whatever happens next will be on your terms - not mine .

Nicholas blinks once , clearly caught off guard by how quickly she twisted things aroundbut after just a brief pause , his lips curl into an almost reluctant smile .

NICHOLAS MERCER

(LOW , AMUSED)

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You're quick-witted . Very well consider it done .

Their eyes lock firmly across that small cafe space neither willing nor able yet fully admit what simmers beneath all these

calculated moves : attraction or pure strategy ?

Then- footsteps approach again . The door swings wide open once more /

GARRETT VALE

(STERN TONE)

Enough ! What do you think you're doing here ? This isn't some playground !

Both Renata & Nicholas snap their attention immediately towards him surprise flashing briefly across each face before

they steel themselves anew under his watchful glare.

/ END EPISODE 12

EPISODE 13

Garrett's sharp gaze flickers between them, his tone laced with frustration.

GARRETT VALE (CONT'D)

This is serious business. You can't just show up and

He stops mid-sentence as he fully takes in the scene before him: Renata seated calmly across from Nicholas, their eyes locked in

a tense but unmistakably charged exchange.

GARRETT VALE (CONT'D)

(FROWNING DEEPLY)

Renata what exactly is going on here?

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Nicholas leans back casually, crossing one leg over the other. His voice carries that same low amusement as he meets Garrett's

stare directly.

NICHOLAS MERCER

Relax. We're simply discussing a potential partnership. Nothing more.

Renata tilts her head slightly toward Nicholas, smirking faintly at Garrett before turning back to face him

squarelyher confidence radiating like heat off polished steel.

RENATA WELLS

(COOLLY DELIBERATE)

We are partners now officially . And I intend to honor that commitment , regardless of how inconvenient it may be for some .

Her words hit hard; even Garrett falters under their weight for a moment before forcing himself to respond firmlybut

there's an edge of vulnerability beneath his sternness.

GARRETT VALE

(VOICE CRACKING SLIGHTLY)

Renata you don't have to do this! There are other waysways we can work together without

Before he can finish, Renata cuts him off sharply with a raised hand and an icy glare that silences every word in its wake

.

RENATA WELLS

(INTERRUPTING COLDLY)

22

No "other ways." This was my choice . And if you truly care about me , then respect it instead of trying to control it .

She rises smoothly from her seat deliberate steps closing the distance between herself and Nicholas as she

reaches out and places one perfectly manicured hand against his chest . Her fingers linger lightly over the fine

fabric of his suit jacket , tracing slow circles across his heart while locking eyes tightly onto Garrett 's stunned

expression .

RENATA WELLS (CONT'D)

(LOW , UNYIELDING)

My loyalty belongs here nowwith Mr. Mercer . Whether anyone likes it or not

The room falls deathly silent once morethe tension thick enough to choke onas all three remain frozen within that single

electrified moment : desire clashing with duty ; pride battling possession ; reason struggling against raw emotion ...

THEN SUDDENLY

A loud CRASH echoes through the cafe as someone slams open another door farther down the hallway !

VOICE FROM THE SHADOWS

(SHOUTING URGENTLY)

Stop right there ! Nobody moves !

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All heads whip toward the source where two heavily armed security guards storm into view , flanking behind them none other

than Victoria Chase herself her heels clicking sharply against marble floor tiles as she strides forward with

calculated menace written across every inch of her flawless posture

VICTORIA CHASE

(SMILING THINLY)

Well well what an unexpected little reunion

Her gaze sweeps slowly over each person presentbefore finally settling squarely upon Renata.../

END EPISODE 13

EPISODE 14

EPISODE 14

Victoria's gaze lingers on Renata, a slow, predatory smile curling at the corners of her lips.

VICTORIA CHASE (CONT'D)
Oh, darling you really think you can just waltz back into my territory and steal my man? That's adorableand incredibly stupid.

Renata steps forward without hesitation. Her voice is cold steel as she meets Victoria's eyes head-on.

RENATA WELLS
You're mistakenI'm not here to steal anyone. Nicholas and I we're partners now. And I have every right to be here.

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Garrett moves instinctively in front of Renata, his body tense with anger as he glares at Victoria.

GARRETT VALE
Enough games. You've caused enough trouble alreadythis ends now!

Victoria chuckles softly but viciously before raising an elegant hand to silence him.

VICTORIA CHASE
Oh Garrett always so dramatic. But this isn't about youit's about her. (her eyes lock onto Renata) You see, little miss "loyalty", being with Nicholas was never your choice in the first place

She pauses for effect before delivering the final blow with sharp satisfaction.

VICTORIA CHASE (CONT'D)
It was me who picked him for youa perfect match made by yours truly...

The words hit like a slap across Renata's face; her breath catches momentarilybut then she exhales slowly, regaining control

almost instantly.

RENATA WELLS

(CHUCKLING DARKLY)

Congratulations on convincing yourself that narrativeyou must feel very proud of your delusions right now...

Nicholas finally steps forward between them againhis expression unreadable but his tone razor-sharp as he addresses

Victoria directly:

NICHOLAS MERCER

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(FIRM)

Enough! This has gone far beyond petty jealousy or business rivalry . If either one of us wanted , this could escalate

into something much bigger something neither side would want .

His glare shifts smoothly from Victoria back to Renatawith unmistakable ownership lingering beneath it .

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)

And make no mistake : My loyalty belongs where it always has . With whoever stands beside me . Whether that makes sense to

any of you doesn't matter anymore .

He reaches out , fingers brushing lightly against Renata 's waist a silent claim sealing their alliance once more .

The room holds its collective breath again ; tension crackling through every nerve ending ...

THEN SUDDENLY

A sharp SNAP echoes from behind themthe sound coming from one of the cafe ' s large windows near the entrance !

Everyone whirls around simultaneously only to find another figure emerging through shattered glass : Sophia Chase , striding

inside like a storm incarnate , flanked by several security guards dressed entirely in black ...

SOPHIA CHASE

(LOW , COMMANDING)

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I said nobody leaves until this mess is cleaned up properly !

Her voice rings out clear and uncompromisingsending shockwaves rippling straight through every person present ...

END EPISODE 14

EPISODE 15

EPISODE 15

INT. CAFÉ LOBBY - CONTINUOUS

Sophia's piercing gaze sweeps the room, her presence exuding absolute authority.

SOPHIA CHASE
Nobody leaves. This situation requires proper resolution.

The security guards move in, positioning themselves strategically around the group.

GARRETT VALE
(STEPPING FORWARD)
Sophia, this isn't necessary. Let's talk this through calmly

Before he can finish, Sophia cuts him off with a sharp gesture.

SOPHIA CHASE
(CALCULATING)
Talk? At this point? You're all involvednone of you walk out until I say so.

Her eyes lock onto Renata and Nicholas with particular intensity.

SOPHIA CHASE (CONT'D)

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And as for you two... your little game has disrupted everything. There will be consequencesboth personal and professional.

Nicholas steps protectively in front of Renata, his expression cold but composed.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(FIRMLY)

We've already made our decision regarding our partnership. And that won't change because of threats or intimidation tactics from anyoneeven someone like you, Sophia Chase.

Renata glances at Nicholas briefly before turning back to face Sophia head-on, her voice steady despite the tension

thickening the air between them.

RENATA WELLS

(CALMLY DEFIANT)

I stand by my choice tooand if that makes me an enemy to some people then so be it.

Garrett clenches his jaw visibly; Victoria smirks smugly while clutching Garrett's arm tighter than before.the power play intensifies visibly as each character stakes their claim within this brewing storm...

END EPISODE 15

EPISODE 16

EPISODE 16

INT. CAFÉ DAY

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The air crackles with tension as Sophia's gaze shifts to Renata, her eyes narrowing dangerously.

SOPHIA CHASE

(LOW, VENOMOUS)

You think you can just waltz in here and claim Nicholas? Do you even realize what kind of storm you're stirring up?

Renata stands her ground, meeting Sophia's glare without flinching.

RENATA WELLS

(CALMLY)

I'm well aware. But I also know where my loyalties lieand it's not with someone who thrives on manipulation and intimidation.

Sophia scoffs dismissively but doesn't back down.

SOPHIA CHASE

(SMIRKING)

Bold words for someone so clearly out of their depth. You have no idea what you're dealing with.

She turns sharply toward the exither voice carries cold authority as she speaks to the guards behind her.

SOPHIA CHASE (CONT'D)

(OPENING THE DOOR WIDER)

Open it up. Let everyone see exactly how far gone this little circus really is.

The café doors swing open with a loud creak, revealing several more SECURITY GUARDS lined up outside. They step inside

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methodically, their presence amplifying the already suffocating atmosphere within the room.Renata stiffens slightly but

remains composed; Nicholas steps closer beside her protectively while Garrett visibly tenses at the growing threat

around them

GARRETT VALE

(URGENTLY STEPPING FORWARD)
Sophia! This is unnecessarywe can resolve this peacefully

Before he finishes speaking, one of Victoria's THUGS suddenly lunges forward from behind him and slaps him hard across

his face!

THUG #1

(BARKING)
Shut your mouth!

Garrett staggers backward in shock and painthe café falls into stunned silence before chaos erupts again...

Victoria watches gleefully as Garrett stumbles toward Renatawith calculated crueltyshe yanks off Renata's hat roughly

from behind!

VICTORIA CHASE

(MOCKING LAUGHTER)
Well look at that... our dear little rival has been hiding all along under that pathetic excuse for style! What a joke!

Nicholas immediately moves to shield Renatabut before he can react furtherthe thugs surrounding them close in quicklyand

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within secondsthey've stripped away every piece of clothing she was wearing until only underwear remains exposed on her

body!!

Her cheeks flush violentlynot just from embarrassment but sheer rageas she glares daggers back at Victoria through

tear-filled eyes

RENATA WELLS

(FURIOUS HISS)
You... disgusting bitch...

Nicholas instinctively reaches outto cover or protectbut stops himself mid-motion when he realizes there's nothing left

uncovered between them anymore Instead He swiftly grabs a nearby tablecloth draped over an empty chairand wraps it tightly

around both himself and Renata like armor shielding against humiliation.)

NICHOLAS MERCER

(GRITTING TEETH FIERCELY)

No one humiliates my partner like thisand gets away cleanly!

END EPISODE 16

EPISODE 17

Nicholas stands firm, his jaw tight with fury as the tablecloth shields them both. His eyes blaze toward Victoria and her

lackeys.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(LOW, DANGEROUS)
Touch her again, and I'll make sure you regret it for life.

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The café remains tenseno one dares move. Even Sophia's grip on control falters under Nicholas's unyielding presence.

VICTORIA CHASE

(SMIRKING CRUELLY)

Oh? You think a little cloth is enough to stop us? Let's see how long your honor lasts in front of all these people!

She gestures sharplyand without hesitation, the thugs close in tighter around Renata and Nicholas.

GARRETT VALE (O.S.)

(FURIOUS SHOUT)

Enough!

Everyone turns at once. Garrett storms into the café from outsidethe door slamming shut behind him with authority.

His gaze locks onto Victoria immediately. Without breaking stride, he strides forward and delivers a brutal kick

straight to her side.

Victoria gasps sharplyher smug smile vanishing instantly as she stumbles backward in shock and pain.

GARRETT VALE

(VOICE DRIPPING VENOM)

You dare lay hands on my wife?!

The room freezes againthis time under Garrett's commanding presence rather than Nicholas's cold intensity. The tension

spikes higher than ever before

END EPISODE 17

32

EPISODE 18

EPISODE 18

The entire room erupts into chaos.

VICTORIA CHASE

(SNARLING, FURIOUS)
Who the hell do you think you are?!

She lunges forward, but before she can make contact, Garrett steps inhis arm snapping out with brutal speed to deliver

a sharp punch that sends her sprawling back onto the ground.

GARRETT VALE

(VOICE COLD AND UNRELENTING)
I'm the man who doesn't tolerate anyone crossing my wife. And trust methat includes you.

Sophia's expression twists in rage. She rushes at Garrett next, but Nicholas intercepts her effortlesslygrabbing her

wrist and twisting it sharply until a pained scream escapes from between clenched teeth.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(LOW, CONTROLLED FURY)
You're lucky I don't break your hand right here. Let go of her!

SOPHIA LARKIN

(STRUGGLING)
W-what are you doing?! You're supposed to be on my side!

Nicholas meets her gaze with icy disdainand then shifts his attention back to Renata without hesitation.

33

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)

(FIRMLY)

Renata Wells I hope this is enough proof for you now.

He gestures toward Garretttheir connection unmistakable under the harsh café lights.

RENATA WELLS (O.S.)

(SHOCKED VOICE)

What? He's

Before she can finish, Nicholas cuts in smoothly:

NICHOLAS MERCER

(CALMLY AUTHORITATIVE)

My brother-in-law. Married to my sister Victoria's best friendyou know how tight those social circles run. But let me make one thing clear: he will always stand by your side as long as I do too.

A stunned silence falls over everyone present once againthe weight of their revelation settling heavily into the air

like an impending storm about to break loose

END EPISODE 18

EPISODE 19

EPISODE 19

The room falls into stunned silence. Renata's mind races, her voice barely a whisper.

RENATA WELLS

(SHOCKED)

So Garrett is your brother-in-law?

34

Nicholas nods smoothly, his gaze sharp and unwavering.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(CALMLY)
Yes. And that means as long as I stand by you, he will too. Do not mistake loyalty for weakness.

Sophia's face flushes with rage and humiliation. She glares at Renata before turning to Nicholasher voice dripping with venom.

SOPHIA LARKIN

(FURIOUS)
You're siding with her? Over me?

NICHOLAS MERCER

(ICY CALM)
I side with the truthand right now, it favors Ms. Wells.

Victoria steps forward, her expression twisted in fury and disbelief.

VICTORIA HARTLEY (O.S.)

(SNARLING)
This can't be happening! You're really choosing them over us?

Nicholas turns slowly toward Victoria, his eyes darkening like a storm cloud ready to break.

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)

(LOW, DEADLY SERIOUS)
Enough of this farce. Today ends herewith whoever stands by my sister standing by me against those who cross the line.

35

He extends his arm toward Renata once morea silent command wrapped in unyielding authority: It's time to leave together. Renata hesitates for just a fraction of a secondthen takes it without looking back. As they exit side by sidetheir silhouettes framed perfectly against the café windowsthe tension left behind crackles

like static electricity.

END EPISODE 19

EPISODE 20

INT. CAFÉ - CONTINUOUS

The café door swings shut behind Renata and Nicholas.

Inside, the atmosphere is electricSophia's eyes blaze with fury while Victoria seethes in disbelief.

SOPHIA LARKIN

(SCREAMING)

This isn't over! You've just made your biggest mistake!

VICTORIA HARTLEY

(SNAPPING)

How could you choose her? Over us?

The two women exchange a venomous glare before turning their wrath toward each other.

SOPHIA & VICTORIA (UNISON)

(HISSING, FURIOUS)

She started this!

Their voices clash like thunder as they escalate into a heated argument, drawing attention from nearby patrons who quickly

36

distance themselves.

CUT TO:

EXT. CITY STREET MOMENTS LATER

Renata steps out onto the bustling sidewalk, glancing at Nicholas beside her. Her expression softens slightlybut only

for an instant before she stiffens again.

RENATA WELLS

(COLDLY)

You're not going to tell me why we left together... are you?

Nicholas meets her gaze squarely, his tone calm but firm.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(FLATLY)

That doesn't matter right now. What matters is that I made my choice and so should you. From this moment on we stand united as siblings first and foremost.

He turns abruptly without another wordhis coat swirling dramatically as he strides away down the street without looking back

at her once.

END EPISODE 20

EPISODE 21

EXT. CITY STREET CONTINUOUS

Renata watches Nicholas disappear into the crowd, her expression a complex mix of frustration and disbelief.

RENATA WELLS

(UNDER HER BREATH, BITTER)

37

Unbelievable... He just left me standing there like some pawn in his game.

She pulls out her phone and dials quickly.

RENATA WELLS (CONT'D)

(INTO PHONE)

Garrett, I need you at my place immediately. Something's gone wrongbig time.

CUT TO:

INT. RENATA'S APARTMENT LATER

The door swings open. Garrett strides in confidently but pauses when he sees Renata's tense demeanor.

GARRETT VALE

(CONCERNED)

What happened? You sounded urgent on the call.

Before she can respond, the sound of heels clicking sharply against marble fills the hallway outside. Both turn toward the

entrance as Victoria storms in without invitation or hesitationher eyes blazing with fury as she cuts straight to Renata

without missing a beat.

VICTORIA HARTLEY

(SNARLING)

So this is what you've been up to behind my back?

Renata stiffens instantly at Victoria's tone wary and defensive while Garrett steps protectively closer beside her.

GARRETT VALE

(CALMLY FIRM)

38

Victoria whatever issue you think we haveit doesn't concern you anymore. You should leave before things get ugly.

Victoria smirks darklya calculated glint flashing through those icy eyesand takes deliberate step forward until she stands

toe-to-toe with Renata, invading every inch of personal space possible under polite social norms.

VICTORIA HARTLEY

(low voice dripping venom)...Oh sweetheart, it concerns me plenty now that your pathetic little affair has escalated into something far more dangerousfor all three of us!

Her gaze flicks coldly toward Garrett for just an instant before snapping right back onto Renata with razor-sharp intensity...

VICTORIA HARTLEY (CONT'D)

(fierce whisper)...You're playing with fire by getting involved with him!

Renata exhales slowlyforcing herself not to flarebut inside tension coils tighter than ever...

CUT TO:

EPISODE 22

Renata exhales slowlyforcing herself not to flarebut inside tension coils tighter than ever.

RENATA WELLS

(CALM, CONTROLLED)

And what exactly makes you think you have the right to warn me?

39

Victoria's eyes narrow, her voice dropping even lowermore calculated than before.

VICTORIA HARTLEY

(SLOW, DELIBERATE)
Because I know Garrett. And if anyone should be cautious about him... it's someone like you.

Garrett stiffens beside Renata, his jaw tightening subtly. But he says nothing yet.

RENATA WELLS

(RAISING AN EYEBROW)
Oh? And what exactly do you "know" about me that would make this relationship dangerous?

Victoria steps closer stillher breath practically brushing against Renata's cheek as she leans in with a

conspiratorial smirk.

VICTORIA HARTLEY

(LOW AND SHARP)
You're innocent. Vulnerable. Too naive to realize how easily he could manipulate youand drag your name through the mud in the process!

Her words hit like ice water straight into Renata's corea mix of fury and humiliation rising fast beneath her skin.

GARRETT VALE (O.S.)
That is enough!

The room falls silent again as Garrett finally snapsthe protective barrier around them cracking just slightly under

Victoria's assault.

He turns sharply toward Victoriawith cold authority radiating from every inch of his postureand cuts through the tension like a blade slicing silk...

GARRETT VALE (CONT'D)

(FIRMLY COMMANDING)

Leave now. Before I decide this conversation needs to continue somewhere less civilizedwith fewer witnesses present.

For a long moment, Victoria stands frozencaught off guard by his sudden shift in demeanoras the weight behind his words hangs heavy between them all...

Then without another word, she spins on her heel and storms outthe sound of high heels clicking sharply against marble echoing down the hallway once more.

CUT TO:

EPISODE 23

INT. SOVEREIGN THRONE INDUSTRIES - LOBBY - DAY

Renata exhales slowly, her gaze drifting to the entrance where Victoria disappeared.

RENATA WELLS

(SOFTLY, MORE TO HERSELF)

I never thought she'd be so persistent

Garrett steps closer, his presence steady and reassuring.

GARRETT VALE

(SINCERELY)

41

Don't let her get under your skin. She thrives on chaosand you're not going to give her that satisfaction.

Renata meets his eyes, a flicker of warmth crossing her features before hardening again.

RENATA WELLS

(FIRMLY)

This isn't over yet. And I won't let anyoneespecially someone like herundermine what we have here.

Before Garrett can respond, Nicholas appears beside them once more, hands casually tucked into his pockets as he

surveys the scene with an unreadable expression.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(CASUALLY SMIRKING)

Well... looks like things are getting interesting between my "siblings."

His words hang in the aira deliberate provocation aimed squarely at Renata and Garrett's fragile alliance. Both turn

toward him immediately; tension crackling between all three of them in silent anticipation.

CUT TO:

EPISODE 24

INT. SOVEREIGN THRONE INDUSTRIES - LOBBY - DAY

Renata's eyes narrow at Nicholas, her voice sharp.

RENATA WELLS

42

(COLDLY)
Interesting? You mean you've been watching us this whole time?

NICHOLAS MERCER

(CHUCKLING SOFTLY)
Of course. It's not every day I get to observe such compelling dynamics between my siblings.

GARRETT VALE

(frowning, stepping closer to Renata)
Nicholas, that's enough. This isn't a game.

Nicholas tilts his head slightly, his gaze flickering toward Garrett with subtle amusement.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(TEASINGLY)
Oh? And what exactly is your role here, brother-in-law-to-be?

Garrett stiffens for a moment but quickly regains composure.

GARRETT VALE

(FIRMLY)
I'm the man who respects boundariesand protects those who matter to me.

Nicholas raises an eyebrow and glances back at Renata with exaggerated charm before turning on his heel and walking away without another word.

Renata exhales sharply, then turns back to Garretther expression conflicted yet resolute.

RENATA WELLS

43

(SOFTENING JUST SLIGHTLY)
Let's not give him more attention than he deserves... Nowabout the project

Before she can continue, her phone buzzes urgently in her hand. She glances at the screen; her face drains of color almost

instantly as she reads the messagea photo attached: Victoria standing closely beside Julian Chase inside Chase Group's

headquarters under a bright chandelier.*

Her fingers tremble as she shows it to Garrett.*

RENATA WELLS (CONT'D)

(HORRIFIED WHISPER)
It's worse than we thought... They're already working together!

GARRETT VALE

(GRITTING HIS TEETH)
Damn it...

He quickly pulls out his phone and dials someone from the security team.*

GARRETT VALE (CONT'D)

(LOW VOICE)
Find out everything about their meeting right now! I want every detail!

As he speaks into the phone call,* Renata stares after Nicholas' retreating figure.* Her mind races conflicted by emotions

tangled between resentment and something far deeper.* Suddenly,* she grabs Garrett by the arm,* pulling him close with

urgency that catches even herself off guard.*

RENATA WELLS

44

(BREATHLESS CONFESSION)
Garrett thank youfor earlier todayfor always being there

She hesitates for a split second before leaning in unsteadilyto kiss him deeply.*

The world around them seems to pausetheir lips locked in desperate needbut somewhere down deep inside*, doubt gnaws

relentlessly at her heart.* What if this is all just fleeting comfort nothing more?

Just thenthe elevator doors open againVictoria strides out smuglywith Julian trailing behind her like an

obedient pet.* Their eyes lock onto Renata immediatelyand Victoria smirks maliciously upon seeing them so intimately entwined.*

VICTORIA BLACKWELL
(sneering deliberately loud enough for everyone nearby)

Well well well Look what we have here.. The poor little step-sister finally found herself some "comfort." How pathetic...

Julian chuckles darkly beside Victoriaas they both take slow deliberate steps toward Renata and Garrett.*

CUT TO:

EPISODE 25

Julian leans in, his voice dripping with venom.

JULIAN SLOAN

(LOW, TAUNTING)
Garrett looks like you've been played. This is just a business arrangementdon't tell me you actually thought she was interested in you?

45

Renata's face flushes bright red as she struggles to pull away from Garrett's grasp.

RENATA WELLS

(DEFIANT)

I don't need your opinion!

She glances at Garrett, guilt flickering across her eyes before turning back toward Victoria and Julian with forced composure.

RENATA WELLS (CONT'D)

(CALM BUT COLD)

Enough of this. What do you want?

VICTORIA BLACKWELL

(SMIRKING TRIUMPHANTLY)

Oh honey, I'm the one who should be asking that. You see... Mr. Chase here has always had a thing for me he even agreed to marry me after we settle on our project together.

Victoria saunters forward and brushes her fingers over Julian's tie.

VICTORIA BLACKWELL (CONT'D)

So now that you've ruined my perfect plan... it only makes sense for him to take care of me instead.

Julian smirks arrogantly and steps closer to Renata.*

JULIAN SLOAN

(MOCKING TONE)

And as for you? Just wait right here while I go get us some champagne. We'll toast to your failureand my step-sister's new

"home."

46

He reaches outhis hand aiming provocatively toward Renata's waistbut before it can touch her

The elevator doors open again.*

Nicholas appears.* He strides forward swiftly.* His gaze sharpens instantly upon seeing the scene before him.*

NICHOLAS MERCER

(VOICE COLD AS ICE)

What the hell is going on here?!

Everyone freezes in place at his commanding presence.* The tension snaps taut around them like a wire stretched too far.*

CUT TO:

EPISODE 26

Nicholas's expression is thunderous. He steps forward, his presence dominating the room.

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)
You! What are you doing to her?

Julian freezes, then forces a smirk as he straightens his tie.

JULIAN SLOAN

(SLICKLY)
Mr. Mercer, this is just my fiancée... and Renata herewell, she's been causing trouble for us lately. I was just teaching her some manners.

Renata stiffens at Julian's words but holds her ground defiantly.

47

RENATA WELLS

(COLDLY)
I'm no one's playthingor lesson. Stay out of this if you value your reputation.

Nicholas narrows his eyes at Renata before turning back to Julian with lethal calmness.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(VOICE LOW BUT DEADLY)
Touching her was your first mistake tonight. Calling me here without reason? That will be your last.

He steps closer to Julian; their gazes lock in a silent battle of dominance.*

JULIAN SLOAN

(SMUGLY UNFAZED)
Oh? And what now? You going to save the damsel in distress?

Before Nicholas can respond, Victoria suddenly claps her hands together with exaggerated delight.*

VICTORIA BLACKWELL

(TEASING TONE)
Well isn't this entertaining! Mr. Chase playing herohow utterly charming!

She saunters over and drapes an arm around Nicholas's shoulders provocatively.*

VICTORIA BLACKWELL (CONT'D)
Come on darling, don't be so tense! Let's all relax... maybe toast to new beginnings?

Her fingers brush deliberately against Nicholas's chesta clear provocation.*

48

Nicholas stiffens visibly but remains composed.* His gaze snaps toward Victoria like a predator eyeing its prey.*

NICHOLAS MERCER (V.O.) *

(ANGRILY RESTRAINED)
Who does she think she is?

The tension between them crackles like static electricityeveryone waiting for it to ignite into something explosive.*

CUT TO:

EPISODE 27

EPISODE 27

INT. LUXURIOUS HOTEL SUITE NIGHT

The atmosphere is thick with tension. Nicholas's eyes remain locked on Victoria, his jaw tight.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(COLDLY)
Get your hands off me.

Victoria smirks, unbothered by his command, and leans in closerher breath brushing against his ear.

VICTORIA BLACKWELL

(TEASING)
Oh come on, Chase you've been so distant lately. Isn't it time to loosen up? Have some fun?

Her hand slides deliberately lower along his chest. Nicholas finally snapshe grabs her wrist and yanks it away with a sharp twist.

NICHOLAS MERCER

49

(HISSING)
Enough!

Victoria stumbles back, clutching her arm but still smiling provocatively.

VICTORIA BLACKWELL

(PLAYFULLY OFFENDED)
Touchy much? You're no fun anymore... Maybe I should find someone who appreciates me better?

She turns to Julian with an exaggerated poutand Julian instantly steps forward to catch her arm like a loyal lapdog.

JULIAN SLOAN

(SLICK SMILE)
Don't be ridiculous, Victoria... He's just stressed out from work. Give him time; he'll come around soon enough.

His gaze flicks toward Renataa thinly veiled insult lingering behind those words.

Renata stiffens but forces herself to stay composed as she meets their disdainful looks head-on.*

RENATA WELLS

(FLAT TONE)
I'm not the issue here. If anythingI'm the one who needs answers tonight

Nicholas exhales sharply through his nose at Renata's words before turning back toward Victoria and Julian.*

NICHOLAS MERCER (V.O.) *

(RESENTFUL)
So they're trying to pin this all on me now...

50

He takes a slow step forwardthe room seems to shrink under the weight of his presence.*

NICHOLAS MERCER

(LOW VOICE)
You want answers? Fine... But first

His gaze sweeps across the room like a judge passing sentence.*

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)

(POINTEDLY)
Clean this mess upor get out of my sight for good!

Before anyone can react, two bodyguards appear from behind curtains flanking both sides of the suite.They move in

near-silence.Their presence feels almost predatory as they close in on Julian and Victoria.Julian freezes instantly.Victoria

gasps softlybut neither dares move further.Nicholas watches them intentlyas if daring them too make even one wrong

move.* JULIAN SLOAN

(STAMMERING NERVOUSLY)
M-Mr.Mercer! This is our private space! What right do you have

Before he can finish,a heavy hand clamps down hard ontohis shoulder.Bodyguard #1 grips him firmly without speaking.Just

then,Nicholas turns slightly toward Renata.A faint smirk flashes acrosshis face.He reaches intohis pocketand pulls

outa sleek card holder.He flipsit open,and slowly slidesone cardonto the polished marble table between them.Renata glances

51

down instinctively.Her eyes immediately lock ontothe name embossedin bold letters: "SOVEREIGN THRONE CAPITAL."" She looks up again,the cornersofher mouth twitching involuntarily.
A sharp intake of breath escapes from Garrett beside her.*

GARRETT VALE *

(LOW WHISPER)*
What what does that mean?

CUT TO:

--- END OF EPISODE ---

EPISODE 28

Renata steps forward, her expression a mix of disbelief and suspicion. She picks up the card, turning it over in her hands as she studies the embossed letters.

RENATA WELLS

(VOICE TREMBLING SLIGHTLY)
Sovereign Throne Capital... What are you doing here?

Nicholas's gaze lingers on Renata for a moment longer before he turns back to Julian and Victoria with cold amusement.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(SMIRKING)
I came to see how my "friends" were treating someone they claim to respect.

He taps the card against the table lightly, his voice dripping with condescension.

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)
And now that I've made my presence known what's your next move?

52

Julian swallows hard, his eyes darting nervously between Nicholas and Victoria. He forces a shaky smile toward Renata,

tryingand failingto maintain control.

JULIAN SLOAN

(FALTERING)

Renata... this is all just a misunderstanding. We didn't mean any harm

Before he can finish, one of Nicholas's bodyguards steps forward again. Without warning, he grabs Julian by the collar and

yanks him upright with brutal force. The room falls silentevery eye locked on them as tension thickens like fog.*

The bodyguard raises an arm slowlya deliberate motionand then slams it down across Julian's face in one clean arc.*

JULIAN SLOAN

(YELPING IN SHOCK)

Ah!

The sharp crack echoes through the suite.Victoria lets outa soft gasp.Julian stumbles backward,bloodspurting fromthe

cornerofhis mouth.He collapsesontofthe sofa,in sheer humiliation.Nicholas watches every second unfold without flinching.*

NICHOLAS MERCER

(LOW VOICE)

Lesson one: Respect isn't optional when you're dealing with meor anyone under my protection.

His gaze shifts smoothly toward Victoria.The look is icy,the threat clear.*

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)

53

(POINTED)
Lesson two: Don't make me regret showing up today.
Victoria trembles slightly but manages to nod quickly.She hesitates for only half a beat before stepping forward cautiously.She reaches outto help Julianbut before their fingers touch,Nicholashaltsher handwithanother firm grip.*
His palm presses against hers,a calculated gesture.That contact sends an unexpected jolt through both of them.A spark ignites beneath their skinthe air aroundthem seemschargedwith subtle heat.*
Then,Nicholas suddenly pivots.His other hand sweeps upward,and catches Renata off guard.He pulls her into his armsin one smooth motion.They collide chest-to-chest.Renatastruggles instinctively,butNicholasholdsfast.*
Her breath hitches.Her heart races.Shecanfeelthethrobofhis pulsejust inchesfromherskin.Their bodies pressed so tightly together,the curveofhischestagainstherownfeelsimpossibletoignore.*
RENATA WELLS

(STRAINED WHISPER)
Let goI'm not part of this!
But Nicholas doesn't respond immediately.Instead,hishandslideupward,to rest firmlyonbothsidesofherneck.He leans in slowlytoo close.The faint scent of his cologne fills her senses.Then,silence.
Suddenly,the sound of glass shattering cuts throughtheroom.*Everyoneturnsinstinctivelytowardsthebalconyd billowing wildly inwardaswindstorms into thesuite.And there,onethousand feet above ground levelis Victorialying sprawledacross thenarrow ledge,outside.the window.*

54

EP 29 TEASER

A collective gasp rips through the crowd.Victoria's eyes snap open wide.Instantly,she jerks uprightwith pure

panic etchedintoeveryline.*

VICTORIA BLACKWELL

(SCREAMING HYSTERICALLY)*

Help! Someone save me! PleaseI'll give anything if you do!

END OF EPISODE 28

EPISODE 29

EP 29

Everyone freezes, horror-stricken.

VICTORIA BLACKWELL

(SCREAMING HYSTERICALLY)

Help! Someone save me! PleaseI'll give anything if you do!

RENATA WELLS

(SHOUTING, PANICKED)

Nicholasdo something!

Julian stumbles forward, shaking violently. His voice cracks with desperation.

JULIAN CLARK

(PLEADING)

I-I'm coming to my senses now... I swear! Just let me goI'll help her!

NICHOLAS MERCER

(COLDLY DISMISSIVE)

You? Help her? You're a joke. Stay right where you are.

55

Renata's eyes dart between Nicholas and Victoria. The wind picks up again, making the curtains flutter wildly. Victoria

clutches at the ledge, trembling as she inches backward inch by inch.

VICTORIA BLACKWELL

(TEARS STREAMING)

If I fall... it's all over for meand my family too!

Her voice breaks on the last word; sobs ripple through her throat.

Suddenlythe room goes deathly silent once more.

Thena faint sound of footsteps behind them.*

Everyone spins around in unison.*

The doors burst open.*Two bodyguards rush in without hesitation.*

One moves swiftly toward Julian and Victoriathe other immediately steps forward toward Nicholas and Renata.*Their

faces are grimtheir movements urgent.*

BODYGUARD #1 (TO JULIAN):

Sir! We've secured the building perimeter as ordered. No threats detected outside.

JULIAN CLARK

(BREATHLESS WITH RELIEF)*

GOOD GOOD

BODYGUARD #2 (snapping attention back to Nicholas):

56

Master Merceryou need to get out of here immediately! There's been an alert from Sovereign Throne Capitalwe're not safe

yet!

Nicholas turns sharply toward himwith one cold glance that shuts down any further explanation.*

NICHOLAS MERCER

(AUTHORITATIVE COMMAND)

Get moving. Now.

The bodyguard nods instantly.He pivots without question.And disappears just as quickly into another corridor.*

Nicholas exhales slowly.The tension drains from his shoulders.But before he can turn back to Renata*

A loud CRASH echoes through the suite.

Victoria lets out a terrified scream.

She jerks upright once morebut this time,the glass shatters completely.*

Shards rain down like deadly confetti.

AND BEFORE ANYONE CAN REACT

Victoria tumbles off that narrow ledge

Her scream cuts sharp through the air

BUT THEN*

A firm pair of hands catches her mid-fall.*

They vanish from view for only a heartbeat

Before reappearing fully within sight.*

It is Nicholas holding her effortlessly against his chest.* He lands with controlled grace upon both feet.He plants

them solidly on that balcony edge.No movement.Flawless balance.Victoria clings tightly around his neck,sobbing

57

uncontrollably into his shoulder.Nicholasshiftsherweight slightly.His grip tightens

instinctively.But there is no fear in him.No panic.Everything about him remains composed.Perfect control.*

VICTORIA BLACKWELL (CONT'D)

(SCREAMING HYSTERICALLY)

Thank you so much!

She buries her face deeper into his shoulder.Renata watches silently.Forced smiles flicker across their facesin stark contrast to every emotion burning beneath those calm exteriors.*

Garrett stands frozen nearby.His expression unreadable.As soon as they land safely,Nicholas doesn't hesitate.He releases Victoria first.Then he shifts smoothly.The next secondthey lock eyes.Both bodies tense.A charged silence falls between them.They lean closer.Inch by deliberate inch...

THEN SUDDENLY

WITHOUT WARNING OR WARNING SIGNS,

Their lips collide forcefully in a deep kiss.*

GARRETT VALE

(LOW GROWL)

What the hell?!

He lunges forward without thinking.Nicholas barely flinches.Garrett grabs hold of him firmly by both

shoulders.Andshoves hard.Nicholastumbles backward under sheer force.

Straight onto Renata's lap.

58

Renatasurviveshim.Shegaspedintakesofairandstaresup.Atbothmen,ir

GARRETT VALE (CONT'D)

(FURIOUS GLARE)

What did you just do?! Are you insane?!

EP 29 TEASER END

EPISODE 30

EP 30

Renata jolts upright, instinctively pushing Nicholas away.

RENATA

(ANGRY AND FLUSTERED)

Are you crazy?!

Her hand lands hard on his chest. She glares up at him, eyes burning.

GARRETT

(ENRAGED, TURNING TO NICHOLAS)

You kissed her! What the hell is wrong with you?

Nicholas glances between them, expression unreadable. He adjusts his jacket calmly before stepping back from Renata's lap.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(COLDLY COMPOSED)

I saved her life. I think that entitles me to a kiss.

He turns toward Victoria and offers his arm smoothly.

NICHOLAS MERCER (CONT'D)

Let's go inside before someone else gets hurt today.

59

Victoria clings to him without hesitation as they walk back into the building leaving Garrett fuming on the balcony

while Renata remains seated in stunned silence.

GARRETT

(FURIOUS GLARE AT RENATA)

Did he just... kiss you? Why didn't you stop him?

RENATA

(SHAKING OFF DISBELIEF)

Stop him? Are you kidding me right now?

She stands abruptly brushing dust from her skirt then shoots a sharp look at Garrett before storming past him into the house

without another word. The door slams shut behind her with a finality that leaves Garrett standing therehelpless and

furiousas Nicholas watches silently from beside Victoria across the room.

EP 30 TEASER END

EPISODE 31

EP 31

INT. LUXURY VILLA HALLWAY DAY

Renata strides down the hall, her heels clicking sharply against the polished floor. Her expression is a mix of anger

and disbelief.

RENATA (V.O.)
A kiss? Did I just get kissed by him? And in front of Garrett!

She stops outside a door, takes a deep breath, then opens it

INT. LUXURY VILLA STUDY CONTINUOUS

The room is dimly lit. Renata steps inside, closing the door behind her with a soft click.

GARRETT (O.S.)
Renata! Wait!

She freezes for half a second before turning around to face him fully.

RENATA

(COLD)
What do you want?

Garrett catches up to her, his eyes burning with frustration but tinged with desperation.

GARRETT
You can't just shut me out like thisespecially not now!

He reaches out instinctively but hesitates mid-air as she flinches slightly at his touch.

RENATA

(FLATLY)
Now what? You think I'm going to forgive you because your feelings got hurt?

Garrett exhales sharply and rubs the back of his neck awkwardly.

GARRETT
No... that's not it. It's about usabout everything we've been through together...

61

His voice lowers; sincerity seeps into every word.

GARRETT (CONT'D)
I know I messed up todayI should have stopped him from kissing youbut please... don't let this ruin what we have. Don't push me away like everyone else has in your life...

Renata stiffens at his wordsthe pain flickering across her face before hardening again into resolve.

RENATA

(SOFT YET FIRM)
Garrett my past doesn't define who I am anymoreand neither does anyone else's opinion of meincluding yours

Her gaze locks onto his firmly as she takes another step forwardclosing the distance between them just enough to hold

eye contact without letting emotion slip too far forward.

RENATA (CONT'D)

(FIRM)
Right nowI need spaceto figure things out on my own terms

Before he can respond or protest further,

She turns abruptly and walks toward the window overlooking the balcony below arms crossed tightly over her chest refusing

even one backward glance as she lets silence fill their space instead.

EP 31 TEASER END

EPISODE 32

EP 32

62

EXT. BALCONY - NIGHT

The city lights shimmer below, casting a soft glow. Renata stands alone, her arms wrapped tightly around herself as she

stares into the distance.

INT. HOTEL ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Garrett watches her retreating back from the windowfrustration and helplessness knotting his brow.

GARRETT

(VOICE LOW)

RENATA PLEASE

He reaches out instinctively, but stops himself before touching her shoulder.

His hand drops to his side instead, clenching into a fist.

GARRETT (CONT'D)
I promiseI'll make it up to you somehow... I just need one more chance...

BEFORE HE CAN SAY ANYTHING ELSE,

The door bursts open behind him with force

Nicholas strides in, eyes locked on Garrett like a predator eyeing its prey.

NICHOLAS

(COLDLY AMUSED)
Oh? What's this?

A lover's quarrel? Or have you finally decided to give up on your little girlfriend?

63

Garrett stiffens at Nicholas' wordsthe tension between them snapping tight like a wire about to break.

GARRETT

(GRITTING TEETH)
You don't belong hereleave!

Nicholas steps closer without hesitation,

His gaze sliding over Garrett with deliberate disdain before shifting upward toward Renata through the glass

NICHOLAS

(SMIRKING QUIETLY)
Looks like someone needs rescuing after all...

He turns sharply and locks eyes with Garrett againa challenge flashing in their stare.

NICHOLAS (CONT'D)
But if that girl means so much to you... then by all meansfight for her. Prove yourself worthy of keeping whatever scraps she decides not to throw away tonight.

EP 32 TEASER END

EPISODE 33

EP 33

Garrett's jaw tightens, his entire body radiating tension. He steps forward, voice low and steady.

GARRETT

(FIRMLY)
You're the one who needs saving. She doesn't belong with someone like you.

64

Nicholas laughs softlya sound that sends chills down Garrett's spine.

NICHOLAS

(AMUSED)

Oh? And what exactly makes you think she belongs with you?

Their eyes lock in a silent battle of willsboth unwilling to back down.

Renata watches from behind the glass, her expression unreadable as she grips the railing tightly.

RENATA (V.O.)

(SOFTLY)

This... this isn't love. It's just two men fighting over me like some prize...

Her gaze shifts toward Nicholas, lingering for a moment before turning cold again toward Garrett.

RENATA (V.O.) (CONT'D)

(SIGHING INTERNALLY)

And neither of them is worth it...

Suddenly, Renata steps back from the railing and turns awayher decision clear in her posture. Without looking back or

uttering a word, she strides purposefully into the building interior, leaving both men stunned on the balcony.

Garrett exhales sharplythe fight draining out of him as he stares after her retreating figure in disbelief.

GARRETT

(SOFTLY TO HIMSELF)

What... did I do wrong?

65

Before Nicholas can respond, he too remains frozenhis smirk fading into something far more complicated as he

watches Renata disappear inside.

EP 33 END

EPISODE 34

EP 34

INT. HOTEL LOBBY - DAY

Renata steps into the lobby, her heels clicking with purpose. She pauses, then turns sharplyher eyes locking onto

Nicholas through the glass.

RENATA (V.O.)

(COLDLY)

I've made my choice.

With that, she strides away without hesitation.

EXT. HOTEL BALCONY - CONTINUOUS

Nicholas watches her retreating figure, a slow smile curling at his lips.

NICHOLAS (V.O.)

(SATISFIED)

Of course you did.

His phone buzzes in his hand. He glances down and answers smoothly.

NICHOLAS

(INTO PHONE)

Yes?

INTERCUT WITH:

66

INT. CORPORATE OFFICE DAY

Lance stands by the window of an opulent office, sunlight filtering through floor-to-ceiling windows behind him. His expression is smug but controlled as he speaks into the phone.

LANCE

(PLEASED)

She's accepted your dealthe one where you become Sovereign Throne's new CEO? And what about our arrangement?

Nicholas leans against the balcony railing, looking out over the city with quiet amusement in his eyes.

NICHOLAS

(CHUCKLING SOFTLY)

Don't worryI'll handle Garrett for you soon enough...

He ends the call and slips his phone back into his pocket before heading inside without another glance back at Renata.

END OF EPISODE 34

EPISODE 35

INT. RENATA'S LUXURY APARTMENT - NIGHT

Renata stands by the window, gazing out at the city lights. Her phone buzzes.

TEXT MESSAGE:

From Nicholas: Deal sealed. Congratulations on your new position as CEO of Sovereign Throne.

67

She stares at the message for a long moment, her expression unreadable.

RENATA (V.O.)

(COLDLY)
An empty victory... and a lifetime in his debt.

Her fingers tighten around the phone before she turns away from the window, heading toward her bedroom with slow

resolve.

CUT TO:

INT. SOLEMN BANQUET HALL NIGHT

The grand hall is illuminated by chandeliers, filled with guests dressed in formal attire. Renata walks down a red

carpet toward an ornate stage where NICHOLAS stands waiting to crown her as CEO of Sovereign Throne Industries.

AS THEY REACH CENTER STAGE

A LOUD BANG echoes through the room. The doors slam open dramatically, drawing every eye to Garrett Vale standing tall

and defiant in the entrancewayhis presence commanding attention like thunder breaking silence.

GUESTS WHISPER among themselves; some turn away awkwardly while others watch with wide-eyed anticipation.

Garrett strides forward without hesitation until he stops just inches from Renata's sidethen smoothly takes her hand instead

of letting go onto Nicholas's shoulder as protocol dictates .

68

GARRETT

(FIRMLY)
Congratulations but this isn't over yet , Renata .

Nicholas freezes mid-crown gesture , his face twisting into disbelief before snapping into cold fury .

NICHOLAS

(SHOUTING)
You insolent fool! What are you doing here ?

GARRETT

(SMILING SLIGHTLY)
I came because I care about Renata more than anyone else ever will...

He gently squeezes her hand once more before turning his sharp gaze back toward Nicholas .

GARRETT (CONT'D)
And I'm not going to let you take what belongs to me .

Nicholas snarls under his breath , stepping closerbut before he can react further

THE LIGHTS CUT OUT SUDDENLY . The entire hall plunges into darkness except for two SPOTLIGHTS illuminating Garrett and

Renata's faces their eyes locking fiercely even in shadow .

END OF EPISODE 35

EPISODE 36

69

The room is silent, tension thick in the air as shadows flicker across anxious faces.

RENATA
(calmly, her voice cutting through the darkness)
Enough. This charade needs to end.

She steps forward with quiet authority, her hand slipping from Garrett's grip as she turns to face Nicholas squarely.

RENATA (CONT'D)
I accepted your deal because it was logical. But don't mistake that for loyaltyor love.

Nicholas stiffens, his expression hardening as he clenches his jaw tightly.

NICHOLAS
(BITTERLY)
You chose me didn't you? So why are you so cold now?

Renata meets his gaze steadilyher tone unapologetically firm.

RENATA
Because I'm not a prize to be won or lost on a whim. And this corporate game we're playing? It's exhaustingand frankly, pathetic.
(she pauses briefly before turning away)
Let's keep things professional from here on out. That's all I'll ever owe you... and vice versa.

Her words land like ice against Nicholas' skin; he watches her retreating figure with growing fury before abruptly spinning

70

toward Garrett instead his glare razor-sharp .

NICHOLAS (CONT'D)

(FURIOUS HISS)
This isn't overneither of you will walk away clean!

He storms off without another word , leaving the room buzzing with unsettled energy .

Garrett exhales slowly then turns back toward Renata , offering his arm once morebut this time she takes it without hesitation .

GARRETT

(SOFTLY SMILING)
Come onwe should leave before chaos erupts again at your "coronation."

They exit side by side , their silhouettes disappearing into the lingering darkness .

END OF EPISODE 36

EPISODE 37

INT. HOTEL SUITE - NIGHT

Renata and Garrett enter the suite, shutting the door behind them. The room is dimly lit, exuding a cozy atmosphere.

GARRETT

(RELAXING)
Finally away from all that madness.

He moves to pour two drinks from a decanter on the sideboard. Renata leans against the wall, arms crossed, watching

71

him quietly.

RENATA

(FLATLY)
This isn't over eitherNicholas won't give up so easily.

Garrett hands her a glass and joins her by the window overlooking the city lights. She takes it without looking at him.

GARRETT

(CASUAL BUT FIRM)
Let him try. I'm more interested in what happens next with us.

Renata finally turns to face him fully, raising an eyebrow in silent challenge.

RENATA

(SKEPTICAL)
Us? You mean this "marriage of convenience" you proposed?

Garrett steps closer, his expression softening as he cups her cheek gently with one hand. His thumb brushes lightly along

her skina deliberate tease of intimacy just out of reach.

GARRETT

(SOFT SMILE)
Convenient or not... I've come to appreciate having you by my sidefor real now,

he pauses briefly before lowering his voice slightly,

and maybe something more than partners in business and politics?

72

Renata's eyes flicker for an instantsurprise mixed with contemplationbut she quickly masks it

behind a cool smirk as she takes another sip of wine .

RENATA (V.O.)

(MUSING INTERNALLY)
If only he knew...

She sets down her glass deliberately , stepping back into shadow .

RENATA (OUT LOUD)

(TEASING TONE)
Well then Mr.Vale . Looks like we have some "real" things to discuss tomorrow morning .

Without waiting for his response , she turns sharply on heel , vanishing into darkness beyond balcony doors .

Garrett exhales softly half amused , half intrigued then follows after her.

END OF EPISODE 37

EPISODE 38

INT. RENATA'S PENTHOUSE NIGHT

The door slides shut behind her with a soft click. Renata leans against it for a moment, eyes closed.

RENATA (V.O.)

(SIGHING)
I should've known better than to provoke him...

73

Suddenly, the lights flicker back on. She spins aroundGarrett stands in the middle of the room, leaning casually against the doorway.

GARRETT

(SMILING)
You forgot one thing: I live here too.

Renata crosses her arms, raising an eyebrow at him.

RENATA

(TEASING)
So you're just going to stand there and wait?

Garrett steps closer, his gaze locking onto hers with quiet intensity.

GARRETT

(SOFTLY)
No I'm waiting for your answer about last night's "real" discussion.

He reaches out slowly and tucks a loose strand of hair behind her eara deliberate touch that lingers longer than necessary.

Renata stiffens slightly but doesn't pull away.

Her lips curve into a sly smile as she meets his eyes directlychallenging yet playful .

RENATA

(LOW TONE)
My answer? You'll have it... after breakfast tomorrow morning .

She turns sharply , slipping effortlessly into shadow once more .

74

Garrett exhales softly half amused , half exasperated then follows without hesitation .

END OF EPISODE 38

EPISODE 39

EPISODE 39

INT. RENATA'S PENTHOUSE MORNING

Sunlight filters through the curtains, casting a warm glow across the room. Renata stretches lazily, her bare feet

sliding off the edge of the bed as she sits up.

The door creaks openand Garrett steps in, dressed casually but impeccably.

He pauses when he sees herthen smirks.

GARRETT

(TEASING)
Breakfast is ready. Shall we?

Renata lifts an eyebrow, crossing her arms with a playful tilt of her head.

RENATA

(SMIRKING)
Lead the way, then.

They move toward the living room togetherGarrett takes out two plates from a sideboard and sets them down on a low

table near the floor-to-ceiling window.

The view overlooks Central City's bustling streets belowthe city alive with movement and light.

75

Garrett gestures to one of the chairs before settling opposite her himself, his eyes lingering just a moment too long

before he picks up his fork.

RENATA

(CASUALLY INSPECTING FOOD)
Not bad... you know your way around breakfast tables.

GARRETT

(SMILING SOFTLY)
I aim to please my guests. Especially those who keep me waiting at night for answers about "real" discussions."

Renata feigns innocence as she sips coffeebut suddenly leans forward slightly toward him , locking eyes with deliberate

intent .

RENATA

(LOW TONE)
And? What's your answer?

She lets it hang therea challenge wrapped in amusement .

Before Garrett can respond , their phones buzz simultaneously on separate tables nearby . Both glance at their screens

expressions tightening instantly .

ON SCREEN: An email titled "Project Termination Notice." The sender is clearly hostile: Victor Davis from Apex Capital

Group.]

GARRETT & RENATA (V.O.)

(SHOCKED; SIMULTANEOUS)
What?!

76

They exchange a quick glance alarm flashing silently between them .

Then both leap into action without hesitation , grabbing their coats and rushing out together .

END OF EPISODE 39

EPISODE 40

EPISODE 40

INT. HOTEL LOBBY DAY

Renata and Garrett burst into the hotel lobby, breathless.

GARRETT

(URGENT)

We need to find Victornow!

They split up, scanning the crowd. Renata's phone ringsshe answers immediately.

RENATA (V.O.)

(INTENSE)

What do you want?

VICTOR (O.S.)

(COLDLY)

Miss Wells, I trust you received my email. Your project is done.

RENATA

(FURIOUS)

YOU CAN'T JUST

VICTOR (O.S.)

(INTERRUPTING; ICY)

77

Watch your tone. This isn't a negotiation anymoreit's an order.

Renata clenches her jaw, gripping the phone tighter as she turns toward Garrett.

GARRETT

(GRIMLY DETERMINED)
Let's not give him that satisfaction. We'll handle this together.

They exchange a look of silent resolve before sprinting out side by side.

EXT. CITY STREET CONTINUOUS

The wind whips through their hair as they race down the sidewalk in sync determination etched on every line of

their faces .

Suddenly , Victor appears ahead flanked by two imposing bodyguards . He smirks coldly at them .

VICTOR

(MOCKING)
Well , well... if it isn't Miss Wells and Mr.Vale . What a surprise .

His gaze flickers over them with thinly veiled disdain then he gestures sharply toward his guards .

VICTOR (CONT'D)
Escort these pests back to security for "discussion."

The bodyguards move forward without hesitation .

78

Garrett steps protectively in front of Renata , blocking one guard with swift precision while pulling her behind him .

A tense standoff ensues everyone holding their breath.

Suddenly , another figure emerges from around corner .

It's Nicholas Mercer.

He strides forward smoothly eyes locked onto Victor with unmistakable authority.

NI CHOLAS

Enough.

END OF EPISODE 40

EPISODE 41

EPISODE 41

INT. SOLEMN OFFICE HALLWAY DAY

The bodyguards freeze mid-step, their faces shifting from confusion to immediate respect.

BODYGUARD A

(WHISPERS)

Mr. Mercer...

79

Nicholas stops in front of Victor, his presence magnetic and commanding.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(VOICE LOW, DEADLY CALM)
You just crossed a line you'll regret.

Victor smirks arrogantly, unfazed by Nicholas's sudden appearance.

VICTOR

(LAUGHING COLDLY)
And who exactly are you to stop me?

Nicholas turns slowly toward Renata and Garrett, eyes sharp as steel but flickering with concern for her safety.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(FLATLY)
I'm the one who owns this company the one responsible for everything that happens here. And I say: back off!

Garrett steps forward instinctively, shielding Renata once more. His tone is fierce but respectful.

GARRETT VALE

(TO NICHOLAS)
Sir... it's not what it seems

Before he can finish, Nicholas raises a hand to silence him and then directs an icy glare at Victor.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(cutting through the tension like a blade)
Enough talk. You will leave now or face consequences far worse than humiliation.

80

Victor's smile fades instantly; uncertainty creeps into his expressionbut he quickly masks it with forced bravado.

VICTOR

(SNARLING SLIGHTLY)

Fine... we'll see how long your "protection" lasts.

He signals sharply to his guards again.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

Escort them out!

The bodyguards hesitate for only half a second before retreating respectfully under Nicholas's watchful eye.

AS SOON AS THEY'RE GONE

Renata exhales deeplyrelief flooding her featuresand glances gratefully at Garrett before looking up at Nicholas with

curiosity mixed with awe.

RENATA WELLS

(LOW VOICE)

Thank you Mr.Nicholas Mercer? But why would someone like you care about protecting me?

Nicholas meets her gaze steadilyhis expression unreadable yet intensely focused.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(FIRMLY)

81

Because I've been watching you for some time now Your work ethic is impressiveand franklyI'm intrigued by your resilience

His words hang in the air between thema subtle challenge laced beneath unexpected admiration.

GARRETT VALE

(INTERJECTS AWKWARDLY)

Uh sir! This isn't really appropriate timing

Before he finishes speakinga faint sound echoes down the hallwaythe unmistakable noise of footsteps approaching fast.

VOICE (O.S.)

(SHOUTING URGENTLY)

Boss! Something happened!

Both men turn sharply toward the source of noisetheir expressions snapping into alertness as new tension surges through the room.

END OF EPISODE 41

EPISODE 42

The door bursts open, and a breathless assistant stumbles in.

ASSISTANT

(PANICKED)

Sir! Victor's men have broken into the building. They're forcing their way up!

82

Nicholas's expression hardens instantly. He turns to Renata, his voice sharp but controlled.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(TO RENATA)
Stay here. I'll handle this.

Renata steps forward, blocking his path with unexpected determination.

RENATA WELLS

(FIRMLY)
I'm not staying behind while you face danger alone. We're partners nowwhatever happens, we face it together.

Nicholas freezes for a moment before letting out a low chuckle of disbelief.

NICHOLAS MERCER

(SMILING SLIGHTLY)
Partners? You really think this is some kind of game?

Before he can say more, the sound of shattering glass echoes from outside the rooma loud crash followed by heavy

footsteps storming down the hallway.

VICTOR (O.S.)

(TAUNTING)
Well well looks like my little "surprise" finally reached you two lovebirds!

Victor strides into view flanked by several guardstheir smirks dripping with malice as they close in on them like

predators circling prey.

GARRETT VALE

83

(stepping protectively beside Renata)
You won't get away with this, Victor!

Victor laughs coldly and gestures toward Garrett dismissively before locking eyes with Nicholashis gaze laced with venomous challenge.

VICTOR BLACKSTONE

(SNEERING)
And you Mr. Merciless Alpha... I've been waiting for our final showdown long enough.
His words hang heavily between them as tension coils tightready to snap at any moment.
Suddenly one of Victor's men lunges forward without warning.
But Nicholas moves faster than thought grabbing Garret and pulling him aside just as another guard comes crashing through the window behind them .
Glass explodes everywhere shards raining down like deadly rain .

Renata gasps , instinctively shielding herself .

Garrett stumbles , barely keeping balance amidst chaos .

The world tilts violently - time slows -

AND THEN

A single shard catches her cheek .

Blood blooms instantly against her skin

She cries out sharply , clutching her face

HER VISION BLURS

PAIN SEARS THROUGH EVERY NERVE

84

Then everything goes dark .

END OF EPISODE 42

EPISODE 43

EPISODE 43

INT. NICHOLAS' OFFICE - NIGHT

Renata lies on the couch, a thick bandage wrapped around her cheek. Her eyes flutter open slowly.

NICHOLAS (O.S.)
You're awake.

She turns to see Nicholas sitting nearby, his expression unreadable but attentive.

RENATA
I thought I'd never see you again... Thank God you're here.

Nicholas stands and crosses the room in two steps, crouching down beside her. He gently lifts her chin with one hand,

examining the wound with care.

NICHOLAS
That was reckless of me. You could have died back there

Renata interrupts him softly, touching his wrist lightly to stop him.

RENATA
It's not your fault. If it weren't for you... I don't want to think about what would've happened next...

85

Her voice trembles slightly as she lowers her hand and looks away toward the window outsideher reflection distorted by

raindrops sliding down the glass.

Nicholas stiffens at first but quickly masks his emotions behind a calm facade before reaching into his coat pocket and

pulling out an envelope from inside it he hands it over to Renata .

NICHOLAS

This is what we discussed earlier The rights transfer agreement , signed by Mr.Blackstone himself .

He pauses briefly before continuing .

NICHOLAS

(SOFTLY)

Sovereign Throne has always supported your project . It's just that some people opposed us because of their own interests . Now that those obstacles are gone , your project can move forward smoothly again ...

A flicker of surprise crosses Renata's face as she takes the documents from Nicholas' hand .

RENATA

(SINCERELY)

Thank you ... so much ...

Then without warning , She reaches up suddenly , wrapping both arms tightly around Nicholas' neck in an embrace

pressing herself close against him .

86

Their bodies align perfectly : chest against chest ; hip against thigh; breath mingling together in heated rhythm...

For a moment everything else fades away leaving only them suspended within this intimate bubble of shared emotion...

Nicholas freezes initially stunned by her sudden affectionbut then instinctively wraps his arms around Renata's waist ,

pulling her even closer into an engulfing hug .

His lips brush hers softly once more before breaking contact reluctantly :

NICHOLAS

(LOW TONE)

There'll be time later for this Right now we need to get moving or things will escalate too far

He gently loosens their embrace and guides Renata toward the doorbut just as they begin walking out together

VICTOR BLACKSTONE (O.S.)
Stop right there!

They both turn sharply toward Victor standing at hallway entrance flanked by several bodyguardshis gaze burning with

malice while pointing directly at them).

Victor strides forward arrogantly without waiting for permissioneach step deliberate ; radiating dominance & control over

entire situation like predator stalking prey).

87

The tension between these three figures crackles visibly through air like static electricity ready ignite any second

END OF EPISODE 43

EPISODE 44

EPISODE 44

Victor's presence sends a ripple of unease through the room. Nicholas immediately tenses, his protective instincts flaring.

NICHOLAS

(COLDLY)

What are you doing here?

VICTOR

(smirking, voice dripping with arrogance)

Oh, just came to see my old friend and her charming companion. Didn't expect such an intimate scene.

Renata stiffens slightly but quickly composes herself, stepping forward with quiet confidence.

RENATA

(FLATLY)

Victor. What exactly do you want?

VICTOR'S SMILE WIDENS IT'S CLEARLY A TACTIC TO PROVOKE THEM BOTH.

VICTOR

(TEASINGLY)

Come on now. Don't be so cold. I'm here because I have business to discussand maybe rekindle some old feelings?

88

Nicholas steps in front of Renata without hesitation, blocking Victor's line of sight as he glares at him sharply.

NICHOLAS

(FIRMLY)

There's nothing to discuss about feelingsonly business from now on. And if your intentions threaten her project or personal safety again

Nicholas' warning hangs heavy in the air before it is interrupted by Victor's mocking laugh.

VICTOR

(SARCASTICALLY AMUSED)

Oh please! You think you can stop me? You're nothing more than a puppet hanging off her arm!

He glances pointedly at Renata then back at Nicholas clearly trying to sow discord between them .

RENATA (V.O.)

(QUIET DETERMINATION)

I won't let him manipulate us...

Before she can say another word , Victor suddenly turns toward the exit . His bodyguards follow closely behind .

Their retreating figures leave a lingering tension in the space between Renata and Nicholas .

Nicholas exhales slowly , running his hand along her waist once more before he finally loosens their embrace completely .

His eyes meet hers with unspoken promise:

NICHOLAS

89

(LOW TONE)

LET'S GO

They turn together , leaving behind only their intertwined shadows as they step back into the corridor ready for whatever comes next.

EPISODE 45

INT. HOTEL LOBBY - DAY

Renata and Nicholas enter the lobby, their movements synchronized.

Nicholas pulls out a black card from his wallet and hands it to her with a slight smirk.

NICHOLAS

(SMOOTHLY)

This is your new credit card. It's linked directly to my accountno limits.

He pauses, glancing at her with an unreadable expression before adding:

NICHOLAS (CONT'D)

But rememberthis isn't charity. Your business success benefits us both.

Renata takes the card, flipping it between her fingers thoughtfully.

RENATA (V.O.)

(QUIET RESOLVE)

I'll prove that I can stand on my own... even if he doubts me right now.

She meets Nicholas' eyes firmly, slipping the card into her purse without hesitation.

90

RENATA (CALMLY)
Thank you but don't worryI'm not planning to rely on anyone else's resources. Especially not yours.

Nicholas chuckles softly, clearly amused by her determination as they move toward the exit togethertheir partnership

unspoken yet undeniably solid beneath every interaction.

EPISODE 46

INT. HOTEL LOBBY - DAY

Renata and Nicholas stride side by side, their steps perfectly in sync.

Nicholas pulls out a sleek black card from his wallet, holding it up with a faint smirk.

NICHOLAS
(SMOOTHLY)
This is your new credit card. It's linked directly to my accountno limits.

He pauses briefly, eyes flickering over her with subtle amusement before continuing.

NICHOLAS (CONT'D)
But rememberthis isn't charity. Your business success benefits us both.

Renata takes the card without hesitation, flipping it between her fingers as she locks eyes with him steadily.

RENATA (V.O.)
(QUIET RESOLVE)
I'll prove I can stand on my own even if he doubts me right now.

91

She slips the card into her purse deliberately, meeting his gaze without wavering.

RENATA (CALMLY)
Thank you but don't worryI'm not planning to rely on anyone else's resources. Especially not yours.

Nicholas chuckles softly at her determinationa low sound of genuine amusement rather than condescension. He

turns smoothly toward the exit, extending an arm for hers as they walk togethertheir partnership unspoken yet undeniably solid

beneath every interaction.

AS THEY REACH THE DOOR

Victor Blackstone suddenly appears behind them, blocking their path with a venomous glare aimed squarely at Renata and then

shifting toward Nicholas in thinly veiled contempt.

VICTOR

(SNEERING)
Well well... Looks like Mr.Mercer has finally decided to throw in his lot with this little project manager?

The air thickens instantly; tension spikes visibly between all three.
A tense silence falls before Nicholas finally breaks itwith sharp authority that commands immediate attention.

NICHOLAS

(COLDLY)
Enough talk , Victor . Move aside or I will have security escort you out .
Victor sneers again but says nothing more instead stepping back reluctantly , allowing Nicholas and Renata to pass through first .

92

Once outside , free from Victor 's shadow , Nicholas leans slightly closer toward Renata just enough for her to catch the faintest hint of warmth beneath his usual stoic exterior .

NICHOLAS

(SOFTENING SLIGHTLY)

Use whatever you need . But keep me informed about anything important happening within your company .

Renata nods firmly without hesitation ; no trace of doubt remains visible on either face .

Their connection remains steadyand unmistakably realeven when unspoken .

SUDDENLY

Her phone buzzes sharply from inside her purse .

She glances down quickly , frowning at an incoming message :

["Project Alpha" Has Been Terminated]

Her breath catches instantly ; panic flashes across her features as she stares blankly at the screen .

RENATA (V.O.)

(SHOCKED DISBELIEF)

What ? How could this happen so fast ?

BEFORE SHE CAN REACT FURTHER

Another notification pops up almost immediately :

[YOU HAVE RECEIVED $50 MILLION]

93

Confusion floods through Renata's mind while relief rushes in simultaneously .

She looks up instinctively searching for answers from Nicholas nearby .

Instead he simply tilts his head ever so slightly towards The Wells Group headquarters across the street ; lips

curling into that same quiet smirk once more .

NICHOLAS

(NONCHALANT)

Looks like someone just decided to invest heavily after all.

His voice carries no judgmentonly calm observation.

Renata blinks rapidly , realization dawning slowly .

THEN,

SHE BURSTS INTO LAUGHTER.

EXT. OUTSIDE THE HOTEL CONTINUOUS

The two share a brief moment of mutual understanding before turning their attention back toward The Wells Group

building ready once again To face whatever comes next together.

94

END OF EPISODE 46

EPISODE 47

INT. HOTEL LOBBY CONTINUOUS

The sound of Renata's laughter hangs in the air, sharp and incredulous.

RENATA (V.O.)
$50 million? That's more than what my entire company is worth!

She turns to Nicholas, eyes wide with disbelief.

RENATA
Who who did this?

Nicholas tilts his head slightly toward The Wells Group headquarters across the street. His lips curl into that same quiet smirk once more.

NICHOLAS (NONCHALANT)
Looks like someone just decided to invest heavily after all.

His voice carries no judgmentonly calm observation.

Renata blinks rapidly, realization dawning slowly. Then

SHE BURSTS INTO LAUGHTER.

EXT. OUTSIDE THE HOTEL CONTINUOUS

The two share a brief moment of mutual understanding before turning their attention back toward The Wells Group buildingready once again to face whatever comes next together.

END OF EPISODE 47

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EPISODE 48

INT. HOTEL LOBBY CONTINUOUS

Renata's laughter fades, replaced by a sharp, determined smile.

RENATA
Well I guess this makes things interesting.

She turns on her heel and strides toward the exit with purpose. Nicholas follows closely behind, his expression unreadable but attentive.

EXT. OUTSIDE THE HOTEL CONTINUOUS

The cool evening air hits them as they step outside. Renata looks up at The Wells Group headquarters across the streetits glass facade gleaming under the city lights.

RENATA (V.O.)
An anonymous $50 million investment whoever did this must have some agenda. But why?

NICHOLAS (BREAKING SILENCE)
Curious about who helped you?

Renata glances at him, surprised by the question.

RENATA
Of course I am! This isn't just charityit's strategic. Someone wants something from me or my company.

Nicholas nods slowly, considering her words.

NICHOLAS

96

Agreed. And now that you're aware of it... You need to be careful moving forward.

He steps closer and hands her a sleek USB drive without breaking eye contact.

NICHOLAS (CONT'D)
Inside is everything you'll need for tomorrow's shareholders meetingthe true blueprint to securing your company's futureand exposing those who wish to manipulate it from within.

Renata takes the USB drive firmly in both hands, feeling its weighta tangible reminder that she is no longer alone in this fight.
Her eyes flash with renewed confidence as she meets Nicholas' gaze head-on.

RENATA
Then let's show them we're ready.
They share a brief looka silent agreement between two partners united against an unseen enemyas they turn back toward their destination together.

END OF EPISODE 48

EPISODE 49

INT. LUXURY HOTEL BALLROOM NIGHT

The grand chandelier sparkles as the crowd buzzes with excitement. Renata stands at the center, poised and radiant in an elegant gown, her confidence magnetic.

Suddenlyfootsteps approach from behind. She turns to see Nicholas stepping forward, his gaze locking onto hers with quiet intensity.

97

Nicholas steps closer, lowering his voice just enough for her ears alone.

NICHOLAS
Rememberyou're not alone tonight.

Renata meets his eyes without hesitation.

RENATA
I never was. Thank you for everything.

Their fingers brush brieflya charged moment that lingers longer than either intendsbut then the room shifts again as

more guests arrive. They part naturally but their connection remains palpable across the space between them.

Across the roomGarrett watches them intently from a distance, a faint shadow of jealousy flickering across his face

before he quickly masks it with a polite smile toward Renata's direction.

GARRETT (V.O.)
Who is this man? Why does she look so different around him?

He shakes off the thought and refocuses on mingling among other guestsbut even then, his eyes keep drifting back to Renata and

Nicholas standing side by side like equals in power and grace under pressure.

CUT TO:

EXT. HOTEL BALCONY MOMENTS LATER

Renata steps outside for fresh airthe cool night breeze brushing against her skinas she gazes out over city lights twinkling

98

below. The door behind her creaks open softlyand Nicholas quietly slips out beside her without making a sound or

drawing attention to himself first entering.*

They stand shoulder-to-shoulder in comfortable silence for several seconds before he finally speaks again.*

NICHOLAS (LOW)
You know... I've always admired your strengthfrom afar.*

Her lips curl into an amused yet thoughtful smile.*

RENATA (TEASINGLY)
From afar? So you weren't watching me all these years?

His expression darkens slightlyhis voice dropping lower still.*

NICHOLAS
Maybe I was too afraid to get close... afraid of losing control.* He reaches out suddenlyto gently tuck a loose strand of hair behind her ear.* His thumb brushes lightly along her jawline toward where their noses almost meet,* lingering there as if reluctant to let go.* RENATA
(softly) Then why now?

Nicholas leans in slowlytheir breaths intertwiningthe tension building until they can no longer resist

But just as their lips are about to meet

The balcony door swings open sharplyand Garrett storms outside without warning*

99

His hand snatches at Nicholas' wrist mid-motion* gripping tightly with possessive force*

GARRETT
What do you think you're doing?!

Nicholas freezes instantly under Garrett's sudden confrontation*, turning fully toward himwith shock flashing through

every muscle of his body*

BEFORE ANYONE CAN REACT FURTHER

A loud CRASH echoes from insidethe sound shattering stillness like thunder breaking through calm skies*

All three turn sharply back into the room

ONLY TO FIND CHAOS UNFOLDING WITHIN

END OF EPISODE 49

EPISODE 50

INT. RENATA'S APARTMENT NIGHT

The room is in shamblesfurniture overturned, shards of glass scattered across the floor. Renata stands frozen,

eyes wide with disbelief.

RENATA

(VOICE TREMBLING)
What... what happened here?

Garrett rushes to her side, his expression filled with guilt and urgency.

GARRETT
Renata! Are you okay? I swear, this wasn't supposed to happen!

He glances at Nicholas standing nearby, then lowers his voice.

GARRETT (CONT'D)
It's him he came back for you. When I refused to let him near meI guess that angered himand things got out of control.

Nicholas steps forward smoothly, his gaze locking onto Renata's with an unsettling calmness.

NICHOLAS
You don't need someone like him in your life anymore. You should be minecompletely and utterly mine.

Renata stiffens at his wordsthe tension between them thick enough to suffocatebut before she can respond

A sudden movement from the shadows behind Nicholas catches everyone off guard: a figure lunges forwarda sharp blade aimed straight at Nicholas's chest

Without hesitationGarrett throws himself into the path of dangerwith a roar of defiance

His body shields Nicholas as the knife sinks deep into his side

Blood blossoms instantly across Garrett's shirtthe sound of impact echoing through the shattered room.*

RENATA
(SCREAMING)
Garrett!!!

101

She drops everything and rushes forwardtears streaming down her face as she cradles Garrett in her arms.* Her fingers tremble violently while pressing against his wound.*

RENATA (CONT'D)
Please... stay awake! Don't leave me!

Her sobs shake her entire frame her heart breaking further with every ragged breath he takes.*

NICHOLAS

(CALMLY STEPPING CLOSER)

Let me take care of this mess instead...

Before anyone can react he reaches outand gently lifts Garrett from Renata's arms.* His touch is eerily softas if handling something fragile yet insignificant.*

With effortless grace he carries Garrett toward the balcony edge .*

Renata freezes completely , horror etched deeply into every line on her face .

And just when it seems all hope might be lost

Suddenly the bedroom door bursts open again .*

Two security guards storm inside without warning , their bodies tense like coiled springs ready to snap .*

GUARD 1

(SHOUTING SHARPLY)

Sir ! We've secured everything outside !

102

Nicholas turns slowly toward them , expression unreadable but undeniably commanding .

NICHOLAS

(NODDING ALMOST IMPERCEPTIBLY)

Good . Take over from here .

He hands off Garrett without another word . Then turns back toward Renata , finally closing that infinitesimal gap between

them once more .

Their lips meet againin one single heated motion that leaves nothing unsaidor unresolved

END OF EPISODE 50

EPISODE 51

Nicholas pulls back slightly, his hand lingering at the nape of her neck. His voice is low, almost a whisperdangerous

and intoxicating.

NICHOLAS

You're mine now. No one else gets to have you. Not him not anyone.

Renata's breath catches in her throat. Her eyes flicker with shock before narrowing into defiance.

RENATA

(VOICE TREMBLING BUT FIRM)

I'm not your possession, Nicholas! I never was!

Their gazes lockelectricity crackling between them.

103

Suddenlythe sound of Garrett groaning breaks the tension.

Garrett staggers out onto the balcony, clutching his side as blood seeps through his fingers. His face pales when he sees

Renata and Nicholas locked together in that intimate holda storm of jealousy and pain erupting behind his eyes.

GARRETT

(BREATHLESS, VOICE BREAKING)
Renata what's going on here?!

BEFORE SHE CAN ANSWER

The bedroom door slams open againand this time it's Victor Blackwood, flanked by several top executives from Sovereign

Throne Industries' boardroom security detail.* Their expressions are cold steel.*

VICTOR (O.S.)

(FIRMLY COMMANDING)

Enough! This farce ends now!

Everyone freezesthe air snapping tight with authority.*

Victor strides forward without hesitation .*

His gaze sweeps over Renata , then locks onto Nicholas .

VICTOR

(LOW GROWL)

Step aside , or be removed by force .

104

Nicholas tilts his head slightly toward Victor a slow smirk curling across his lips .*

NICHOLAS

(MOCKING AMUSEMENT)

Oh? The mighty Victor Blackwood himself has come to save Miss Wells ?

He leans closer to Renata his breath warm against her cheek .

NICHOLAS (CONT'D)

(TEASINGLY POSSESSIVE)

What should we do with our little hostage situation , hmm?

Renata stiffens her jaw tightening as she stares down both men

RENATA

(COLD RESOLVE)

Let me make something perfectly clear : I am no one's hostage . Especially not yours , Nicholas .

Her gaze shifts sharply to Victor unflinching

RENATA (CONT'D)

And as for you... don't think for a second that your "rescue" will change anything between us .

Victor scoffs softly , stepping closer toward her

VICTOR

(SNEERING)

105

Don't flatter yourself . You're nothing more than collateral damage in this game...

His words hang heavy in the airthreatening chaos at any moment

END OF EPISODE 51

EPISODE 52

Nicholas suddenly steps forward, his hand gripping Victor's collar with a terrifying strength.

NICHOLAS

(LOW, DANGEROUS)
Touch her againI'll dismantle your entire empire piece by piece.

Victor chuckles darkly, unfazed.

VICTOR

(ARROGANT)
Oh? And what will you do without Garrett? You're nothing without him. You'll crumble just like your pathetic project did.

Renata's eyes flash with defiance as she crosses her arms tightly over her chest.

RENATA

(CUTTING)
You're rightI am nothing to you now. But that doesn't mean I'm going to kneel and beg for scraps of mercy either. So keep dreaming if you think I'll bow down because of some "hostage" situation.

She glares at both men, unyielding in her stance. Nicholas exhales slowly, expression unreadable before he shifts his

106

gaze back to Victor with razor-sharp focus.

NICHOLAS

(FLAT TONE)

Enough talk. Let's settle this properly you and me . Now .

Victor smirks knowingly and nods toward the door behind them

VICTOR

(CONFIDENT)

Fine . The old warehouse out backlet's see who ends up on their knees begging first .

He gestures dismissively before turning on his heel

VICTOR (CONT'D)

(SMUG GLANCE OVER SHOULDER)

Oh , and Renata ? Keep playing the "strong woman" act all you wantbut don't be surprised when reality comes crashing down around you .

With that , he strides away his footsteps echoing through the tense silence

The room feels charged , every breath heavy with anticipation

Nicholas watches him go before finally releasing his grip on Renata .

His hand lingers briefly near hers almost... protective

But then he turns sharply toward the exit , voice cold as ice

NICHOLAS

(COMMANDING)

107

Get our people ready . We're ending this tonight .

Renata exhales slowly , steadying herself against the rush of emotions still swirling beneath her skin . Her gaze

drifts downward for a momentthen snaps upward again as Nicholas leaves

Her lips press into a thin line ; determination hardening like steel within her bones

Suddenly - She spins around sharply - walks straight towards Garrett's wheelchair.
She grabs it firmly by both sides.
Her eyes are filled with tears but also determination.
Slowly - she pushes it forward...

Behind them- only empty space remains.

CUT TO BLACK

END OF EPISODE 52

EPISODE 53

The wheelchair glides forward, the sound of its wheels scraping against the floor echoing in the silent room. Renata's grip

tightens instinctively as she pushes, her breath catching with every inch of distance they put between themselves and

Nicholas.

RENATA (V.O.)
I can't let this end like this. Garrett deserves better... I deserve better.

108

Her tears fall silently, tracing cold paths down her cheeks as she stares aheadher vision blurred but unwavering.

Suddenly, a sharp creak sounds behind them.

Renata freezes mid-push, heart lurching. She spins around slowlyeyes wide with shockbut sees nothing but empty space

where Nicholas had stood moments ago.

RENATA

(WHISPERING)

Nicholas?

She takes a tentative step back toward the exitbut it remains just out of reachthe door sealed shut by his command to prepare

their people.

Frustration wells inside her chest. Her fists clench tightly at her sides before loosening again in quiet surrender.

RENATA (V.O.)
There's no turning back now...

With one last glance over her shouldera mix of regret and resolveshe turns fully to face forward once more. Her hands find

the wheelchair again; fingers wrap firmly around its frame as she begins to push anewwith renewed determination burning

brightly beneath tear-streaked eyes.

CUT TO BLACK

END OF EPISODE 53

EPISODE 54

109

EPISODE 54

The wheelchair glides forward through the dimly lit corridor. Renata's breath is shallow, her heart pounding with every

turn.

RENATA (V.O.)
Just keep moving... there has to be a way out...

She pushes harder, desperation fueling her strength. The building feels endlesseach corner hiding unseen threats.

Suddenly, footsteps thunder behind them.

Renata spins around in panicbut again, no one appears. Only silence and shadows remain.

Her grip falters for a split secondand then

A sharp crack echoes through the hall.

The wheelchair jolts violently as Renata loses control of its direction. It veers sharply toward a narrow side exita door

barely ajar at the end of the passageway.

Without hesitation, she steers toward it and bursts through into blinding daylight.

EXT. ALLEYWAY NIGHT

Outsidethe cold night air hits her like a shockwave. Her eyes widen as relief floods her senses for just an instant.

BUT THEN

110

From both ends of the alleywayfigures emerge from shadowed doorways and dark corners alikeall dressed in black tactical gear with faces obscured by masks.

RENATA (V.O., HORRIFIED)
NO THIS CAN'T BE HAPPENING

She slams on the brakes instinctivelybut it's too late.

Two masked men step forward from opposite sides simultaneouslythey each grab one handle of the wheelchair without hesitation.

MASKED GUARD 1
Hold tight! We've got her!

Their grip is unyieldingtheir movements practiced and preciseas they lift Renata off balance and carry her backward into their waiting arms without resistance or struggle.

Renata gasps in shockher hands instinctively reaching upward to protect herselfbut before she can react further,

A commanding voice suddenly cuts through the chaos like steel.

NICHOLAS (O.S.)
Well done.

111

END OF EPISODE 54

EPISODE 55

EPISODE 55

Nicholas steps into the dim light, his expression unreadable but his presence undeniably commanding.

NICHOLAS

(TO THE MASKED GUARDS)

Take her to my private estate. Secure every exit. She's not leaving until I say so.

The guards nod in unison and begin moving forward again, their grip firm as they carry Renata through the shadows.

Renata struggles weakly against them, panic rising in her eyes.

RENATA (V.O.)

NO THIS CAN'T BE HAPPENING

She slams on the brakes instinctivelybut it's too late.

Two masked men step forward from opposite sides simultaneouslythey each grab one handle of the wheelchair without

hesitation.

MASKED GUARD 1

Hold tight! We've got her!

Their grip is unyieldingtheir movements practiced and preciseas they lift Renata off balance and carry her backward into

their waiting arms without resistance or struggle.

112

Renata gasps in shockher hands instinctively reaching upward to protect herselfbut before she can react further,

A commanding voice suddenly cuts through the chaos like steel.

NICHOLAS (O.S.)
Well done.

END OF EPISODE 54
--- END OF PREVIOUS EPISODE (tail) ---

Write episode 55 now, continuing directly from the text above.

Nicholas stands at a distance, watching with cold satisfaction as Renata is carried away by his men. His gaze lingers

for a moment longer than necessary before he turns sharply on his heel and strides back toward Victor.)

VICTOR (COLDLY)
What are you still doing here? Go home already!

Victor grabs Nicholas's arm tightly, refusing to let go despite Nicholas's discomfort.)

VICTOR (CONT'D)
You're just wasting your time with that woman! You have nothing left thereno love... no respect!

Nicholas finally pulls free from Victor's grasp with a sharp jerk of irritation.)

NICHOLAS

113

Enough! I've made my decisionI'm staying right here until she comes back!

He walks over to where Garrett lies immobilized in his wheelchair. He crouches down beside him slowly)

NICHOLAS

(SOFTENING SLIGHTLY)

Garrett... what did you do to make someone so stubborn about you?

GARRETT

(SMILING FAINTLY)

I don't know either...

Suddenlyhis smile fades entirelyand he stares straight up at Nicholas with deadly seriousness.)

GARRETT

But listen carefully: if anything happens to me because of that womanyou'll never see tomorrow's sunrise again.

END OF EPISODE 55

EPISODE 56

EPISODE 56

INT. ABANDONED WAREHOUSE - NIGHT

Renata sits in the wheelchair, eyes flickering with determination.

RENATA (V.O.)
I must find a way out... for Garrett and me.

114

She glances around, spotting a loose nail on the floor near her chair. She maneuvers carefully, dragging it toward herself.

Suddenlyfootsteps echo from the entrance. The masked men return, their faces hidden under shadows.

MASKED MAN #1
You're not going anywhere!

They approach swiftly, grabbing her arms roughly.

RENATA (STRUGGLING)
Let go of me!

Her fingers close around the sharp edge of the nail concealed beneath her sleeve. As one man tightens his grip to lift her from

the chair

With a sudden jerkshe drives it hard into his forearm. He yelps in pain and stumbles backward as she breaks free and rolls

quickly toward an open loading dock door at the far end of the warehouse.

The cold night air rushes in as Renata bursts outside

EXT. DARK ALLEYWAY - CONTINUOUS

The alley is dimly lit by flickering street lamps; trash rustles in scattered piles along cracked pavement walls covered

in graffitiand beyond lies an empty city that feels eerily abandoned at this hour...

Renata pauses briefly to catch her breath but senses movement behind herthe two masked men burst through moments later.)

115

MASKED MAN #2
Stop right there!

She spins instinctivelyonly to collide against another figure standing silently just beyond shadow's edge: Nicholas Mercer.)

Nicholas's expression remains unreadablebut without hesitation he reaches forward and grabs one attacker by collar.)

NICHOLAS
You'll regret ever touching my wife!

He slams him forcefully back into his partnerand both collapse onto each other with groans of pain before crumbling onto cold concrete below them motionless.)

Renata stares up at himsurprise flashing across her face)

RENATA
Nicholas...? You came for me?

His gaze softens instantly; he kneels down beside her wheelchair and gently takes hold of both hands.)

NICHOLAS
Of course I didI'm your husband after all...

A faint smile tugs at Renata's lips as relief washes over them bothfor now.

END OF EPISODE 56

EPISODE 57

116

Nicholas's fingers tighten around hers as he stands, turning toward the alley exit.

NICHOLAS
Let's go home.

Renata hesitates, her eyes searching his face for any sign of lingering resentment or doubt. But all she sees is unwavering devotionsomething she hadn't expected from him after everything.

RENATA (SOFTLY)
Thank you... I thought

Before she can finish, Nicholas lifts her wheelchair with ease and strides forward without another word. The two masked men groan behind them but make no move to follow; clearly intimidated by his presence.

The night air feels colder nowas if the city itself senses that danger has passed. Renata exhales slowly, allowing herself to relax for the first time since this nightmare began.

She glances back once more at the dim alleyway before turning fully toward Nicholasher savior in every sense of the word.

RENATA (FIRMLY)
I'm ready to face whatever comes next... with you by my side.

A flicker of something unreadable passes through his eyesbut then he nods silently and pushes onward into darkness until they disappear completely from view.

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END OF EPISODE 57

EPISODE 58

INT. NICHOLAS'S VILLA - NIGHT

The grand doors swing open, and Nicholas carries Renata inside without hesitation. The house is dimly litquiet, peaceful.

NICHOLAS (SOFTLY)
You're safe now.

He sets her down gently in the living room, then turns to leave.

RENATA (CALLING AFTER HIM)
Nicholas! What about my project? The investors?

Nicholas pauses at the doorway but doesn't turn around.

NICHOLAS
I'll handle it. You just rest for tonight.

His footsteps fade as he disappears upstairs toward his study.

Renata exhales deeply and leans back in her wheelchair, staring out at the city lights through the floor-to-ceiling

windowsher mind racing with both gratitude and uncertainty about what's coming next.

END OF EPISODE 58

EPISODE 59

INT. NICHOLAS'S VILLA - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

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Renata remains seated, her gaze fixed on the city lights beyond the window. The silence hangs heavy.

Suddenly, Nicholas reappears in the doorway, holding a glass of red wine. He crosses smoothly and hands it to her

without breaking eye contact.

NICHOLAS (SOFTLY)
Drink this.

She takes it cautiously, swirling the wine absentmindedly.

RENATA
Nicholas... I can't just let you handle everything for me. My projectmy investorsthey need answers.

He steps closer, leaning down slightly so their eyes meet at level.

NICHOLAS (FIRMLY)
You saved my life onceI owe you more than words could ever repay. Besides your project is important to me now too.

Renata freezes for a moment before pulling back slightlyher expression conflicted but resolute.

RENATA
I'm not used to relying on anyone else like this especially not men who always seem two steps ahead of me in power or wealth. It unsettles me more than I expected

Nicholas chuckles softly and reaches outnot to touch herbut simply resting his hand briefly against hers on the armrest

119

of her wheelchair before withdrawing it with deliberate gentleness as he turns toward the stairs again.

NICHOLAS (TEASING)
Then maybe tonight's about learning how to trust yourselfand maybe having someone watch your back doesn't have to feel like losing control every time?

His footsteps echo up into darkness before she can answer him again.

END OF EPISODE 59

EPISODE 60

EPISODE 60

Renata sits alone in the quiet room, swirling the wine in her glass. The warmth of it spreads through her chest, loosening the tight knot of anxiety she's been holding onto all day.

She takes a slow sip and lets out a soft sigh.

RENATA (MURMURING TO HERSELF)
Maybe trusting someone isn't as terrifying as I thought.

Suddenly, the door opens again. Nicholas steps inside without knocking this time. He crosses to her side with effortless grace and leans down so their faces are inches apart.

NICHOLAS (SOFTLY)
You forgot one thingwhen you saved my life, you didn't just gain an ally. You gained someone who cares about you more than just business.

120

His gaze flicks lower for a brief second before snapping back upintense and unwavering.

NICHOLAS (CONTINUED)
So tonight let me be your partnerin everything.

Renata's breath catches at his words. She sets down the wine glass on the nearby table and slowly rises from her

wheelchair, steadying herself against his shoulder for support as they stand face-to-face under dim light.

A faint smile tugs at Renata's lipsa mix of relief, amusement, and something deeper.

RENATA (TEASING SOFTLY)

YOU'RE NOT SUBTLE AT ALL

Nicholas chuckles lowly then closes that last small distance between themtheir foreheads resting together in quiet

intimacy.

NICHOLAS (WHISPERING)
I'm yours now... body and soul.

Renata leans into him, a sense of calm and belonging settling over her. The weight of the past feels lighter, replaced by hope

for the future they will build together.

The camera pulls back slowly from their embrace as soft music swellsthe scene fading into warm golden light.

FADE OUT

THE END